Ep. #19 | WTF is “Making it” in an Offbeat Career? Nikhil Kamath Ft. Kriti Sanon, Badshah & KL Rahul

[Speaker 2] (0:00 - 0:21)

Okay, so what I wanted to get at by the end of today is the three of you have made it in careers which are unconventional. So I want to know what you did, how you grew up and along the way we'll try and find nuances of what you did differently that worked for you.

[Speaker 3] (0:22 - 0:25)

Oh god, this is like a long question.

[Speaker 2] (0:52 - 1:10)

Okay, we can start rolling again. Hi. What's up?

Okay, so this is very informal. It's a bunch of us, four friends sitting and chatting.

[Speaker 3] (1:10 - 1:11)

Both one is here.

[Speaker 2] (1:11 - 1:12)

Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (1:12 - 1:13)

Hi.

[Speaker 2] (1:13 - 1:16)

Almost building friends. He's from Delhi, so he's late.

[Speaker 1] (1:17 - 1:22)

It's a little shy, quiet. Do not say things about Delhi. I was from Delhi.

[Speaker 2] (1:22 - 1:24)

Why did you leave Delhi if you like it so much?

[Speaker 1] (1:24 - 1:30)

No, I love Delhi, but I love Mumbai also. Which do you like more? Anybody said that you can't like one city more than the other.

[Speaker 2] (1:30 - 1:33)

No, but like is a very relative word. Which do you like more?

[Speaker 1] (1:33 - 2:02)

So I think my core is still Delhi, but I love living in Mumbai because I feel like the city has given me a lot. There's a lot of also freedom in general. I can come home at 4am, 3am from shoot, not feel worried traveling alone.

And I miss Delhi food. I miss Delhi roads. I miss the space that you don't have in Mumbai.

I don't miss Delhi winters. I'm not a winter person at all.

[Speaker 2] (2:03 - 2:05)

So you're okay in this weather? You're not feeling hot today?

[Speaker 1] (2:05 - 2:15)

I'm okay. I mean, I expected it to be colder, which is why I wore like a sweatshirt in this heat of Mumbai. But I feel I can take heat more than I can take cold.

[Speaker 2] (2:16 - 2:20)

So I remember Rahul from back in the day. We would catch up once in a while, no? We did.

[Speaker 1] (2:21 - 2:30)

I mean, but we also met very, very late. Yeah. I mean, I don't think you came out as often earlier in your early 20s.

[Speaker 2] (2:30 - 2:31)

I still don't go out very often.

[Speaker 1] (2:32 - 3:02)

No, but later, I mean, when we were 27, 28, I did see you a lot more. But early stages when, you know, I used to go out a lot in Bangalore. Like you said, Bombay gives you that freedom.

Bangalore gave us that freedom to just go out. There's no, you know, paparazzi culture. No one ever, like, bothered us or disturbed us.

We didn't feel like, oh, we need to behave a certain way because there are cameras in our faces. So we just, we would chill. But I met him quite a lot later on.

But then as we hung out two or three times, I think then I moved to Bombay.

[Speaker 4] (3:02 - 3:03)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (3:03 - 3:05)

And now we're here again after a couple of years.

[Speaker 2] (3:06 - 3:10)

And another thing that we have in common is we three live in the same apartment.

[Speaker 1] (3:10 - 3:10)

Yep.

[Speaker 2] (3:11 - 3:14)

Yeah. It's going to be the new residence.

[Speaker 1] (3:14 - 3:18)

The good is, I come here quite a lot.

[Speaker 2] (3:18 - 3:20)

I actually went to Rahul's in-laws.

[Speaker 1] (3:20 - 3:23)

But weirdly, we've never really bumped into each other in this building. Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (3:23 - 3:25)

But I'm in Bangalore a lot.

[Speaker 1] (3:25 - 3:26)

Yeah, you're hardly here.

[Speaker 2] (3:26 - 3:30)

Yeah. Also, I invited you and you didn't show up. So, out.

[Speaker 1] (3:30 - 3:31)

Because I was working.

[Speaker 2] (3:32 - 3:34)

Nick. We have another friend in common, Vijay.

[Speaker 1] (3:35 - 3:35)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (3:35 - 3:36)

Subramanian.

[Speaker 1] (3:36 - 3:40)

Yeah, who's in this building more for you than for me. And I keep having this conversation.

[Speaker 2] (3:40 - 3:41)

No, I think he's here more for you than for me.

[Speaker 1] (3:41 - 3:59)

Rubbish. Yeah. If he's saying that to you, then I don't know which floor he's going on.

Who else is here? Who else is here? I don't know.

No? Vijay's not that kind of guy, though. Doesn't seem to be.

No, right? No. But my driver always tells me, Vijay sir came here.

[Speaker 2] (4:00 - 4:17)

Should we wait or should we... Should we call? Let's start getting to know each other.

I feel like I don't know enough about Kriti. So, tell us... I'll tell you what we're trying to achieve today.

You three have... You both have made... Made it...

[Speaker 1] (4:17 - 4:22)

You three? I love that you're addressing this chair. This is John Cena.

We should start addressing this chair.

[Speaker 2] (4:22 - 4:23)

Hence, I changed.

[Speaker 1] (4:23 - 4:30)

Mr. India. John Cena is on the show. You just can't see him.

Yeah, Bacha's Mr. India today. Yeah. Like, he's there.

[Speaker 2] (4:32 - 5:30)

Okay, so what I wanted to get at by the end of today is the three of you have made it in careers which are unconventional. But everybody I know either wants to be an actor, a cricketer, a singer. These are things that people really aspire to become.

So, I want to know what you did, how you grew up and along the way, we'll try and find nuances of what you did differently that worked for you. And stuff people can learn from through that. Broadly that.

I feel like someone young who wants to be a cricketer, actor or a singer should watch today and learn something and probably help his endeavor of becoming what he wants to become or she wants to become. So, start with you. Tell us about yourself.

Start from when you were young. Oh God, this is like a long question.

[Speaker 1] (5:33 - 6:18)

Honestly, I was a very, if I can say, shy and a studious and a nerdy kid. Also, I think the firstborn have a little bit of a pressure of like doing well in studies, being this good kid and all of that which I totally had. My mom's a professor, my dad's a CA.

So, I had this very like, which I also believe in. But you know, getting like about 90% and the right grades and all of that. I was also extremely shy.

I had stage fright. So, today when I say that to people, it's a bit shocking. Considering what I do.

I think till engineering, I didn't really know what I wanted to do in life.

[Speaker 2] (6:18 - 6:20)

Did you always have stage fright?

[Speaker 1] (6:22 - 6:54)

So, it was weird because I would be shy I would sort of, you know, hide in my mom's dupatta and I would be like, you know, I'll take my time to like open up to people. I would go to parties. I'll take my mom along when I was a kid, obviously.

And then if somebody would be like, you know, she dances really well. Dance for us. Once I would start dancing, I would be fine.

You know, even in school, once I would start performing on stage or dancing on stage, I was always in the dance troupe. I learned Kathak. So, dancing was like always a passion.

[Speaker 2] (6:54 - 6:56)

When did you start learning dancing?

[Speaker 1] (6:57 - 8:02)

I think when I was five, my mom realized that I danced well and I could dance and I had that like inherent thing in me. So, in my mom's college, you know, you have these college fests and then in the middle, you have fillers. Right?

There's a time between one performance and the other performance. So, sometimes they, you know, put people from the audience and all. So, I just got on.

She put me on stage and I was five and I danced on Akhya Milao Kabhi Akhya Churao and I was like full on there. I used to like copy Madhuri Dixit. And she got the fact that I could dance and she put me in Kathak Kendra in Mandi House.

You know, I did a full-on foundation course. I used to not like classical dance. I used to really hate coming back from school and my mom dragging me 45 minutes to one hour away to learn Kathak.

Why did she do that? Because I feel like she recognized that I had the talent and she wanted to make it a skill.

[Speaker 2] (8:03 - 8:03)

How did she recognize?

[Speaker 1] (8:03 - 8:09)

Because I danced in parties or in like, you know, and she was like, oh wow, you know, she's never learned it.

[Speaker 2] (8:09 - 8:12)

And that was when you were being pushed to dance. That was you choosing to dance.

[Speaker 1] (8:12 - 9:11)

That was me choosing to dance. I would love to dance on Bollywood songs, you know, but

Kathak and all is like a little classical strict. There's a proper class, there's theory and all.

You have to like really give an exam and everything. So, that was a bit too much for me and my interest was more in, you know, songs and like Bollywood dance or all of that. And she was, I'm today glad that she took me to Kathakendra for five years, even though I didn't like it because I think that gives you a base.

You know, it is that base training which just gives your body that rhythm and that grace which you can, today, I never thought I would utilize it. But today I do. And then I was very educated.

So, I was, I always used to like get 90%. I would like stop eating, drinking. If I had an exam, I had to.

I had this pressure of like, I have to do well, you know. And it's a bit of a needing things to be…

[Speaker 2] (9:11 - 9:11)

Validation?

[Speaker 1] (9:12 - 9:14)

No, like a perfectionist sort of a thing.

[Speaker 2] (9:14 - 9:19)

What did getting good marks and people appreciating your dance do for you, emotionally?

[Speaker 1] (9:19 - 9:42)

Obviously, I mean, it is a sense of validation. It's a sense of, you know, feeling proud. It's my, I think my parents also, to some extent, like my mom used to give me, if there's an exam for Maths, initially I was not good at Maths.

I became good at Maths because of my mother. She used to give me like tests at home with proper marks and everything.

[Speaker 3] (9:42 - 9:45)

She's a professor. So, I had that in my house.

[Speaker 2] (9:45 - 9:49)

And closer to your mom than your dad? You mentioned your mom a couple of times, not dad yet.

[Speaker 1] (9:49 - 10:34)

I think my mom was more involved in my studies and in my life. Dad would be also working for

longer. My mom would come back home by lunch.

So, I saw more of her. I'm close to both my mom and dad. I think my dad's also very, very affectionate and very expressive in some ways.

But then, my mom is more of the chatterbox. What's going on in life? All of that.

Wants to know everything. So, she's that. And, sorry, where was I?

Yeah, so she used to give me like these tests and all. And I would sort of answer it. And then, if I didn't get even one question right, she would be like, correct it and give it to me.

Then I would correct it.

[Speaker 4] (10:34 - 10:35)

Do you think mother?

[Speaker 1] (10:35 - 10:45)

I'm more concerned about hitting than my mom. Hmm? Did you get hit?

Yes, of course, I got hit. I mean, roaming around the table, then getting cornered in a balcony and then getting a slap has happened. So, like this?

[Speaker 2] (10:46 - 10:58)

No, no. Like properly? Properly.

Slap, slap, properly. Why was your mom so competitive about how well you do? Did it come from something in her life?

[Speaker 1] (10:59 - 11:49)

I don't really know. I mean, I feel like she, in her own life, has been a very studious kid. She was the first woman who started working in her sort of family.

Women used to not really work. She's done PhD. So, and she fought to do PhD.

So, she didn't really get those privileges. Why fight? Because her parents had the thinking of, what's the point of studying so much?

Just get married now. It was that. So, I feel like she had to fight for a lot of dreams that she wanted to achieve.

And she was always very, you know, against any sort of bias and she would stand up for the right

and all of that. People in her relatives and her cousins and all, nobody was working. So, she was the first one who took up a job.

[Speaker 2] (11:50 - 11:54)

Is your family a conservative family? Not your parents, but broader?

[Speaker 1] (11:54 - 12:16)

No, not really. No? No.

I mean, my parents have not really been conservative. I feel like they've really, which is the reason I'm what I am. But I also feel like my mom's thing on me also comes from the fact that she couldn't really do so much in her life that she wanted to.

You know, she wanted to learn singing. She wanted to learn swimming.

[Speaker 2] (12:16 - 12:17)

Why didn't she do all those things?

[Speaker 1] (12:17 - 12:19)

Because she was not allowed. Because it was a thing, that why do this?

[Speaker 2] (12:20 - 12:22)

Allowed by? Parents. Her parents.

[Speaker 1] (12:22 - 12:34)

Her parents, of course. Her parents. She's done everything that she has after marriage in terms of like, you know, obviously, she learned swimming later.

Till today, she says, teach me how to dance. And I'm like, it's too late now.

[Speaker 2] (12:34 - 12:38)

I can't teach you. Very traditionally good looking woman?

[Speaker 1] (12:39 - 12:39)

Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (12:39 - 12:40)

Yeah? Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (12:41 - 12:41)

But like you?

[Speaker 1] (12:42 - 12:51)

I mean, yeah. I think like she, she in her time was also very tall and very like lean. How tall are you?

Five, nine and a half.

[Speaker 2] (12:53 - 12:54)

Then?

[Speaker 1] (12:56 - 13:21)

Yeah. So I was always like this 90 percenter doing well in school. When I was going to take science, my mom was like, you know, why?

And I was like, you know, I think I like computer science and I like science more than commerce. Like I want to become an engineer, not knowing what an engineer does at all. And she was like, there's a lot of pressure in engineering.

[Speaker 2] (13:21 - 13:25)

Is that again competition? Did you want to do science? Not because you liked it.

[Speaker 1] (13:25 - 13:25)

No.

[Speaker 2] (13:25 - 13:29)

Because the smartest kids in class were doing it? No, not at all.

[Speaker 1] (13:29 - 14:27)

Then? I think just, okay, I genuinely, little bit of whatever computer science I had in my 10th or 9th or whatever, I liked it. And I felt like, ha, software engineering I can do.

I was not so much into accounts in general. My mom's a physics professor, so I was good at physics. Like when, because she would teach me.

So I had slowly developed an interest in physics also. So I was like, this is something I vibe with a little more. But I don't really know what an engineer does.

But okay, maybe I'll make a software tomorrow. And that's why I took it. Even though she was like, you know, science is too much pressure, you know, I don't think you can take pressure.

Because again, I was someone who would get very serious about things, whether it's exam and I would be like, you know, I used to lose my appetite. I would only have a glass of juice. I would keep like walking till I get my course right.

So I was very, that kind. And I still took science.

[Speaker 2] (14:27 - 14:56)

If you had to define your attachment style, what would it be? I'll give you an example. Are you the kind of baby when your mother walked into your room while you were crying and held you, you stopped crying immediately?

Or are you the kind of baby when your mother came into the room and held you, took a long time to stop crying? Or are you the kind of baby when your mother came into the room, you were indifferent to her being in the room and you didn't even cry when she left the room?

[Speaker 1] (14:56 - 15:11)

No, I think one of, out of the first or second, I mean, I can, if I'm holding a lot inside, if at that point, you know, when someone just touches you, you can sort of start crying. I can be that person.

[Speaker 2] (15:12 - 15:13)

Can you stop crying?

[Speaker 1] (15:16 - 15:22)

In some time? It's not instant. Yeah.

If my mood is off, I usually don't want people around.

[Speaker 2] (15:23 - 15:25)

If your mood is off, you don't want people around?

[Speaker 1] (15:25 - 15:32)

I, if my mood is really off, I need to be left alone for some time. If I want to talk and you're there, I may start crying in front of you.

[Speaker 2] (15:33 - 15:34)

And how are you?

[Speaker 1] (15:34 - 15:36)

And if you scream at me, I will 100% start crying.

[Speaker 2] (15:37 - 15:48)

Or you will scream back? No, I'll start crying. Never scream back?

Hardly. When did you shout? The last time you like, lost your cool and shouted at someone?

[Speaker 1] (15:48 - 16:28)

I can sometimes snap. Uh, I used to be a lot more patient earlier. I think my patience over time has reduced a little.

No idea why. Maybe just the stress and lots more happening in life. But, if somebody screams at me, I usually, it's very difficult for me to give back at that moment.

And I almost become like, almost like kind of shocked at what just happened. And then I can start crying. If I feel like a little bit also, I'm at fault.

Um, if I'm not at fault, I may snap a little. But I'll snap, and then after like five minutes, I'll be like, listen, I'm sorry.

[Speaker 2] (16:30 - 16:34)

Usually. In a relationship, are you the one to apologize first?

[Speaker 1] (16:35 - 16:45)

Uh, it depends. If I feel I'm not wrong at all, then I wouldn't. But I would want to sort it out.

I can't.

[Speaker 2] (16:45 - 16:46)

How do you do that?

[Speaker 1] (16:47 - 16:49)

Talk about it. I need to talk about it.

[Speaker 2] (16:50 - 16:53)

If your partner does not give you attention.

[Speaker 1] (16:53 - 16:55)

Psychological analysis is happening.

[Speaker 2] (16:55 - 16:57)

What is going on? I feel like the media shrink.

[Speaker 1] (16:57 - 16:58)

Therapy session.

[Speaker 2] (16:59 - 17:03)

Therapy session is going on. We're trying to get to know you. So deep.

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (17:03 - 17:10)

Take some time. Two, three podcasts. But a little bit snapping.

I'm like soda bottle, you know, and then.

[Speaker 2] (17:15 - 17:18)

Okay. When was the last time you cried? Do you cry often?

[Speaker 1] (17:21 - 17:29)

I mean, I wouldn't say I don't cry. I cry, but not like. If I fight with someone, there's a huge chance I'll cry.

[Speaker 2] (17:31 - 17:32)

How often does that happen?

[Speaker 1] (17:33 - 17:34)

How often do I fight with people?

[Speaker 2] (17:34 - 17:35)

How often do you cry?

[Speaker 1] (17:36 - 17:50)

Not very often, yeah. I mean, I've had phases, honestly, in the past. Maybe four, five years where

I've had phases where I've felt more low in phases.

And those have been more when I was not working.

[Speaker 2] (17:53 - 17:57)

What is this thing with work? Is it validation again?

[Speaker 1] (17:58 - 17:58)

No.

[Speaker 2] (17:58 - 18:00)

What are you working towards? What's the end goal?

[Speaker 1] (18:00 - 18:20)

No, now it's excitement. There's no end goal. In my work right now, there's no end goal because I want to keep working.

I love doing what I do. I want to be on set. It keeps, it makes me feel alive.

I feel like, I like the fact that I wake up having to do a different scene, a different thing every day or maybe I don't feel like it.

[Speaker 2] (18:20 - 18:26)

If I were a genie, and I say Kriti, what do you want professionally today? What would you say?

[Speaker 1] (18:27 - 18:42)

I wanna, I want some really amazing scripts with great roles because it's very difficult to find. Very, very difficult. I definitely want to work with a lot of directors and makers who I haven't gotten the opportunity yet.

[Speaker 2] (18:43 - 18:44)

Why do you think that is?

[Speaker 1] (18:45 - 19:07)

Sometimes it's destiny, right? It doesn't happen. Makers also take very long to make more films.

Directors stay with a film for way long. Way longer than what actors do. And then to find the next and then it's a missed opportunity.

Sometimes you don't fit the role. Sometimes you don't have a connection to reach to that director or whatever. It could be many reasons.

[Speaker 2] (19:08 - 19:18)

But there are so many I feel. Another reason I wanted the three of you is none of you have any legacy that you're coming in from. Does that play a big part even today?

[Speaker 1] (19:21 - 20:25)

Sometimes. I don't have someone who'll make a call. But sometimes, yeah.

I think I've had more of those moments and a little bit of whatever frustration earlier. But it's taken me a decade to reach where I am today. Today there's a little more little lesser to prove.

Like I need to prove myself. That's a little lesser. Why is that?

Because somehow there is a sense of validation that's happened over the 10 years now. Whether it is with the box office or whether it is as an actor. I think I've always been someone who's hungry to be known as a good actor.

Not just have the stardom. So whether it is certain performances or whether you call it the awards or the national award or whatever. I think it gives you a sense of validation that okay I don't need to prove myself now.

I just want to push myself and do what excites me.

[Speaker 2] (20:25 - 20:26)

What is happiness, Kriti?

[Speaker 1] (20:27 - 20:31)

What is happiness? That's such a deep question.

[Speaker 2] (20:32 - 20:32)

Heavy.

[Speaker 1] (20:33 - 20:43)

Heavy. I think just to be at peace in general. To not...

Yeah, to just have a sense of calm.

[Speaker 2] (20:43 - 20:51)

Someone wise once said that happiness is peace in motion. And peace is...

[Speaker 1] (20:51 - 20:53)

I love that line. I'm going to use it.

[Speaker 2] (20:54 - 21:00)

And peace is happiness at rest. You can convert peace into happiness but not happiness into peace.

[Speaker 1] (21:00 - 21:38)

See, happiness is a choice, I feel. It's a choice. You can have everything and not be happy.

And you can have less and still be happy. So I think there are phases that everybody goes through where you're restless, where you're like, you know, frustrated. You feel like you deserve more and you feel like you're not getting it.

Especially in a profession that is so competitive like mine. I've gone through that. I've been...

Now I say I'm in a happy, restless phase. Which is like, I'm happy. I'm calm.

I'm secure. Can you be happy while you're restless?

[Speaker 2] (21:38 - 21:41)

Yeah. How does that work?

[Speaker 1] (21:41 - 21:47)

Because I'm happy with where I am. And I'm... You know, there's a sense of peace and calm and...

[Speaker 2] (21:48 - 21:48)

Then why restless?

[Speaker 1] (21:49 - 21:56)

Restless to what next? To find something that pushes me more to get to the next level.

[Speaker 2] (21:57 - 22:00)

But if you're happy where you are, why do you need to go to some other place?

[Speaker 1] (22:00 - 22:24)

Because you still want to keep evolving and moving. Life has not ended. I'm still restless to do the next thing, to find the next thing, to...

Okay, what else can I do? But I'm still calm. You know, I think sense of peace and sense of security.

You know, where you're not insecure, where you're not... operating under some sort of insecurity or fear. That part is not there.

[Speaker 3] (22:26 - 22:31)

Now it's... Now it's more hunger. Now it's more like ambition in general.

[Speaker 2] (22:31 - 22:32)

Ambition? In a positive way.

[Speaker 3] (22:33 - 22:33)

Yeah. Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (22:34 - 22:42)

I feel like positive and negative is very much up for interpretation of who's viewing it. Would you say hunger for power?

[Speaker 3] (22:43 - 22:43)

No.

[Speaker 1] (22:44 - 23:13)

I don't think I'm hungry for power. Hungry for what? See...

Obviously, there is... You want validation. In my profession, what I do, I'm not the kind of actor who'll be like, Yeah, okay.

I'm very satisfied with my performance. People didn't like it. There was no validation.

It's okay. It's not that. Obviously, when you work hard, you do something different.

You want that sort of validation, to be honest, from people that, Oh my God, you know, I love what she's done.

[Speaker 2] (23:14 - 23:30)

Can I ask if, for you to truly be at peace, we've said validation a bunch of times now. Can you

have peace, which you so aspire to have, while you're also seeking validation? Because validation is an external thing.

[Speaker 3] (23:30 - 23:31)

Yeah, but still, yeah.

[Speaker 2] (23:32 - 23:41)

You can. But the more you seek validation will come at the cost of peace almost. So you're giving up what really matters to you.

[Speaker 1] (23:42 - 25:01)

No, I'm not going against what I want to do anymore. I'll tell you that. There have been phases where, you know, being an outsider, obviously not even knowing what is the right thing to do.

You know, figuring out what you really like doing, what kind of films do you like doing, what has made you feel really good when you were on set and where you were just floating. So I've gone through those phases of also doing, you know, it's a big film and I know it doesn't have so much for you to do, but you know, box office is so important and you must do this. It's such a big project.

There's so many amazing people associated with this film and you know, you have to balance it and do this and that both. And I have gone for it and I've done it. And A, most of the times it didn't end up working.

So I'm like, it's not even the result that it's happened. And then I didn't feel that excitement when I was on set. And I made those decisions and then learnt, okay, this doesn't work for me.

Or I don't want to do this. And to be at peace where I don't feel the need to do certain things, to be at a certain place and choose that I want to do things that I really want to do. That is peace.

[Speaker 4] (25:02 - 25:03)

Right.

[Speaker 1] (25:03 - 25:12)

That's when I'm restless, but I'm still at peace. I can make a choice that I don't want to do this. I don't feel the need.

I'm happy with where I am and now I want to do what I really love.

[Speaker 2] (25:12 - 25:15)

Is that a by-product of financial security?

[Speaker 1] (25:16 - 25:36)

It's not financial. I would definitely say I'm privileged. It's not, I've been a middle-class, I've come from a middle-class family, but it's not like I've ever felt the need to work because I had to earn money.

That wasn't there. My parents were working. I never felt the need.

My parents never made me feel that I don't have money.

[Speaker 2] (25:37 - 25:40)

Anybody who says middle-class on camera gets trolled. Just saying.

[Speaker 1] (25:40 - 25:41)

But I've genuinely been there.

[Speaker 2] (25:42 - 25:43)

CA and PhD.

[Speaker 1] (25:44 - 25:59)

So? I'm a middle-class, whatever. But I've not been someone who's been like extremely rich and wealthy and all of that.

But I've also not been someone who felt, no, no, no, I need to do this for money. That's never been my...

[Speaker 2] (25:59 - 26:01)

And also the definition of wealthy is so relative, right?

[Speaker 1] (26:02 - 26:10)

Yeah, it is. But I feel also for me, like, you know, I have a joint account with my father. I have no idea how much money is coming in, going out.

Really? Even today? Yes, even today.

[Speaker 3] (26:11 - 26:11)

Why?

[Speaker 1] (26:11 - 26:21)

Now I've started being a little more like, okay, tell me how much. You know, when I'm wanting to say, if I'm looking at, okay, you know, dad, I want to buy a house. Then I'm suddenly like, oh!

How much is it, dad?

[Speaker 4] (26:21 - 26:21)

Is it this much?

[Speaker 1] (26:22 - 26:31)

You know? So, that is when I wake up and I'm like, oh! I think that is the reason why I never really...

Maybe it's not been in my nature.

[Speaker 2] (26:33 - 26:43)

But isn't it important to be financially independent in the decision making? 100%. Isn't it like an ingredient of being successful?

[Speaker 1] (26:44 - 26:48)

It's not about success. I just feel like every individual in general...

[Speaker 2] (26:48 - 26:49)

Should be an individual.

[Speaker 1] (26:49 - 26:57)

Should be financially independent. You should never depend on anyone else for money and for your basic needs. You should never have to do anything.

[Speaker 2] (26:57 - 27:08)

No, I meant to allocate the money you're making. As in? Like, what Kriti is earning today.

Shouldn't Kriti, the individual, make the decision of what happens to that money?

[Speaker 1] (27:08 - 27:14)

Yeah, but I do. But I do also have my family and I'm that person who makes a collective decision.

[Speaker 2] (27:14 - 27:32)

Are you a single person from the... I'm not talking about the societal construct of marriage and mother and father and all of that. When you look to yourself, do you see Kriti the individual or do you see the Sanon family?

With sister and father. Sanon, I would correct you. Sanon family.

[Speaker 3] (27:35 - 27:42)

I don't know what that means, honestly. When I look at myself, I look at myself as the individual.

[Speaker 2] (27:42 - 27:50)

If I ask you, where will you be 10 years from now? Close your eyes. Paint a mental image.

Who all feature in that image?

[Speaker 3] (27:50 - 27:51)

Of course, my family does.

[Speaker 1] (27:52 - 28:50)

It's never without that. But of course, when it comes to professional space, then it's just... In my professional space, it's just me.

So that's there. That's... Like, when I think of myself professionally in 10 years then it's more about work.

I'm also the person... I'm very attached to my family. But I'm also more...

Wherever I am, I belong there. So if I go and shoot for like 20 days, I get a scolding that you've not called. So I'm like...

Because I'm surrounded by work people and my team and people from the film. I'm more there. It's very less...

Then I'm like, oh, today I haven't called my mom or my dad or whatever. Or I have to do a FaceTime on the family group chat.

[Speaker 2] (28:50 - 28:52)

Do you call them every day?

[Speaker 1] (28:52 - 28:58)

Not necessarily. I should. But I don't.

But I should.

[Speaker 2] (28:58 - 29:04)

Okay, so we got to age 5. Age 5? Yeah.

Hello. You went to dance school?

[Speaker 1] (29:04 - 29:06)

We've gone to engineering also.

[Speaker 2] (29:07 - 29:14)

But tell us more about your life between 5 and 17 when you go to engineering. 18? How old are you?

[Speaker 1] (29:14 - 29:48)

Yeah, I mean, honestly, I've been... Like I said, that's been... What I've told you till now has been like till my college.

I was a studious nerdy. Slightly shy. Almost ambi-what I would say is what I call myself.

Now in this industry, I've evolved to be a lot more... How do I say it? A lot more talkative, a lot more comfortable, a lot more easily opened up in front of people in general.

I was not this person earlier. Not even in my first 2-3 years of this profession.

[Speaker 2] (29:48 - 29:57)

They say really smart people know when to look stupid. Is that a requirement in the industry that you work in? What?

Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (29:58 - 30:01)

I don't think I can ever do that. I am offended.

[Speaker 1] (30:01 - 30:03)

I'm trying to get my head around what you just said.

[Speaker 3] (30:03 - 30:04)

What he just said.

[Speaker 1] (30:04 - 30:09)

Really smart people... Know when to look stupid. You know when to make yourself look stupid.

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (30:10 - 30:11)

The smartest of people.

[Speaker 1] (30:12 - 30:38)

No, that is an issue with me. That you're able to or you're not able to? Maybe I'm not really smart.

Maybe you don't want to. Maybe I'm not really smart. No, I said maybe you don't want to be stupid.

Yeah, I just feel I don't get that. In fact, I'm usually around me looked at as someone who has very strong opinions or like a lot of questions to ask.

[Speaker 2] (30:38 - 30:43)

If there were three opinions that define your personality what would they be? About the world.

[Speaker 1] (30:45 - 30:56)

Three opinions about the world. You're just asking me tough questions. I was supposed to be a chill scene.

We'll get to the chill stuff. Oh my god. Three opinions about the world.

[Speaker 2] (30:57 - 31:01)

Don't worry about judgment. No, about the world I don't know.

[Speaker 1] (31:01 - 31:02)

I can tell you about myself.

[Speaker 2] (31:02 - 31:09)

Three things that you think are good in the world or bad in the world. Which are on top of mind for you.

[Speaker 1] (31:10 - 31:28)

I feel any kind of biases whether it's on the basis of gender, religion, boundaries, whatever.

Something that I don't like or that bothers me a little at times. I treat people equally and I feel like that's how it should be.

[Speaker 2] (31:28 - 31:30)

Do we really? Does anyone treat people equally?

[Speaker 1] (31:31 - 31:32)

More or less.

[Speaker 2] (31:32 - 31:34)

We live in a country with no dignity.

[Speaker 1] (31:34 - 31:40)

Stature in general sometimes. But when I say treat people I'm talking about kindness. Just being nice.

[Speaker 2] (31:42 - 31:57)

We fiend benevolence a lot. Because it is cool to be benevolent and not malevolent. We often are nice to people because we like the projection of ourselves of being nice to people.

[Speaker 3] (31:57 - 31:59)

No, not everyone.

[Speaker 2] (31:59 - 32:00)

Not everyone.

[Speaker 3] (32:00 - 32:00)

Not everyone.

[Speaker 2] (32:00 - 32:01)

I'm saying people.

[Speaker 3] (32:02 - 32:04)

Some people, yeah. But I feel like...

[Speaker 1] (32:05 - 32:30)

We're also taught from a very young age by your mother. You're taught that, oh, be nice to

people. Be nice to people.

I guess it's just like you want to be nice to people because that's how you're wired. You've been told that be nice to people. You don't lose anything.

I don't know what nice is but you all have your own version of niceness. But what you're taught as a young kid. Are you compassionate?

[Speaker 2] (32:32 - 32:32)

I don't know.

[Speaker 1] (32:33 - 32:33)

Are you detached?

[Speaker 2] (32:34 - 33:23)

I'm detached. I'm very detached. I live alone.

Wherever, whichever city. I often don't see people for many days in a row. And I'm happy like that.

But you have people who affect you? People do affect me, yeah. But somewhere in my mind there is this fascinating theory that for any kind of evolution there has to be a certain level of detachment.

If you fall into the societal mould of the construct of a traditional family I don't know if it's conducive to any kind of evolution or not. I have a lot of questions. I don't have any answers.

[Speaker 1] (33:23 - 33:42)

Evolution is what you feel is the most important thing. Do you believe in love in general? I believe in love.

Because I feel like I feel like people when I'm talking about even validation it's actually love. It is a sense of validation. Is that what love is for you?

[Speaker 2] (33:42 - 33:42)

Validation?

[Speaker 1] (33:43 - 33:58)

No. No, no, no. Love has different forms I would say.

But yeah, I feel like we all want to be loved, be understood, be, you know, connect with people. I think at some level we want that.

[Speaker 2] (33:58 - 34:05)

You know, I love connecting with people but would I describe myself to be a bit more detached than the next guy? Yes.

[Speaker 3] (34:09 - 34:09)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (34:10 - 34:12)

Like I said, I know more questions than I know answers.

[Speaker 3] (34:13 - 34:19)

Rahul is looking like What's going on? We came here to talk about something else. I'm enjoying it.

[Speaker 1] (34:19 - 34:20)

And where is this Mr. India?

[Speaker 3] (34:22 - 34:23)

He's here.

[Speaker 2] (34:24 - 34:29)

We'll be happy for his leg like. Yeah, 100 percent. Let's all clap.

[Speaker 1] (34:29 - 34:37)

Here we go. Give me a standing ovation. Recording.

Is he here?

[Speaker 4] (34:48 - 34:51)

Hi, come. Please.

[Speaker 3] (34:51 - 35:02)

You should wear Mr. India's for the vacation. Because Mr. India was with us till now. Where are you coming from?

[Speaker 4] (35:03 - 35:03)

Chandigarh.

[Speaker 1] (35:05 - 35:07)

Meaning? You've landed?

[Speaker 2] (35:12 - 35:28)

You missed so much. You missed getting to know me. Yeah.

How will you know Kriti now? Why the Sholay t-shirt?

[Speaker 1] (35:30 - 35:46)

It was right here. He asks a lot of questions. Why did you eat this today?

This too. Have you ever thought of like Have you ever done like psychology or something? Have you ever like?

[Speaker 2] (35:46 - 35:47)

I like psychology.

[Speaker 1] (35:48 - 35:50)

I don't know how well a therapist you can be.

[Speaker 2] (35:51 - 35:54)

Because Are you liking it? Are you feeling better already?

[Speaker 3] (35:55 - 35:55)

Not at all.

[Speaker 2] (35:57 - 36:12)

But we'll go back to you. We were talking about Kriti. She was telling us about her life.

She spoke about some proclivities of her personality in her growing up years. We are getting to the part where she goes to college.

[Speaker 1] (36:13 - 36:15)

Then we'll get into We've gone to the part where I went to college.

[Speaker 2] (36:16 - 36:28)

We're at college. Then we'll go transition from college to everything that we see now. Give us some pictures from each of these phases.

As in? When you were 5, 10, 15, 25.

[Speaker 1] (36:29 - 36:56)

I mean, when I was 5, I See, obviously, you don't remember much. It's what you remember is an image of what somebody else has told you. That this happened.

So, in a birthday party, I've seen some images of like me dancing in the middle on Akhya Milao, Kabhi Akhya Charao and stuff like that. Leading my group of cousins in a performance that we're doing. So, those things.

[Speaker 2] (36:56 - 37:23)

You know, funnily enough, because we just spoke of therapy. I went for a session yesterday and my therapist, the task, my homework for the day was find a picture of yourself from when you were 6, 7, 8 years old or something like that and stare at it for 5 minutes every day. Because she feels like I have forgotten so much and so much of who we are today is formed in that 5 to 15 age.

[Speaker 1] (37:23 - 37:28)

But you do forget. I just feel like sometimes it's like memory is full and now it's deleting stuff.

[Speaker 2] (37:30 - 37:38)

That's the thing. It's called attic theory. So, your brain is like an attic.

When you put something new, you've got to take something out.

[Speaker 3] (37:38 - 37:40)

So, it's not just me. It happens naturally.

[Speaker 2] (37:40 - 37:46)

Your problem is me. So, you should really contain the crap you put in there. Like social media is...

[Speaker 3] (37:46 - 37:47)

I know.

[Speaker 2] (37:48 - 37:52)

A very low-hanging fruit to circumvent that problem. But go on.

[Speaker 1] (37:52 - 38:16)

When I was in school, I feel like... Obviously, this really tall girl who used to be a backbencher because she was tall. But otherwise, she would have been a frontbencher.

Standing last in the line of the assembly line in my class. Being in what... In a DPS archive room, they used to...

[Speaker 2] (38:16 - 38:18)

Is there such a thing as too tall?

[Speaker 1] (38:18 - 38:21)

As? Too tall. People say that to me, man.

I get offended.

[Speaker 2] (38:21 - 38:26)

What do you mean? You're too short. Did it make you inferior as a child?

Because somebody else told me this.

[Speaker 1] (38:28 - 38:48)

Not inferior, but I used to at some point get a little conscious of my height. Like somebody would be like, oh my god, I have to click a picture with her. I have to be on my toes and stuff.

And I was like, what do you mean? But I also used to like my height. I used to like the fact that I could wear flats and be okay with it.

I didn't need to wear heels.

[Speaker 2] (38:48 - 38:55)

I just like wearing heels. That must have been after you were older. What about when you were 10?

Was it ever because of your height that you wanted to walk on your knees?

[Speaker 1] (38:56 - 39:04)

No. It happened to me. I don't want to walk on my knees.

Even today, when I'm sitting, there are a lot of people who are like, okay, why are you sitting so straight? But that's a habit.

[Speaker 2] (39:04 - 39:10)

Is that a hindrance to get work? Like, would somebody cast you with a shorter hero?

[Speaker 1] (39:10 - 39:21)

I have only been cast with shorter heroes. There have been very few taller. And how do they cheat that on screen?

That's magic. In general, there are not very tall heroes in our industry. Now, there are still there.

[Speaker 3] (39:21 - 39:22)

Now, there are.

[Speaker 1] (39:22 - 39:50)

Now, there are still there. Earlier, they were lesser. But I feel like there are ways to cheat it.

And I personally feel like chemistry, honestly, of two people is here. What does that mean? It's here.

It's on the face. Like the chemistry of two people is more on the face. How they're feeling for each other, how they're reacting to each other, that is chemistry.

I don't think it has much to do with height. Yes, in our Indian scenario, especially.

[Speaker 2] (39:51 - 39:53)

What is chemistry for you, Kriti?

[Speaker 1] (39:55 - 39:56)

In life? No, no.

[Speaker 2] (39:57 - 39:59)

In the context that you were talking about.

[Speaker 1] (39:59 - 40:25)

On screen? In life. In life.

I think just to be able to have conversations and still also be okay with silence. Not feeling the

need to talk, but you know your partner is your best friend and you can say anything and talk anything. And you sort of sometimes complete each other and know what the other person was gonna say.

I think that's chemistry.

[Speaker 2] (40:26 - 40:39)

We'll all be quiet now. No, you should be able to talk also. I wouldn't know what you want to say.

Okay, go on. Continue. College started, then?

[Speaker 1] (40:40 - 40:45)

So, which school did you go to? D.Peshawar. College, right? What?

[Speaker 2] (40:45 - 40:46)

What? What?

[Speaker 1] (40:46 - 41:05)

And college? J.P. Institute. Yeah.

A. I was a shy person getting a lot of attention, which a shy person doesn't usually want. I think I was also to some extent not that confident.

[Speaker 2] (41:05 - 41:05)

At what age?

[Speaker 1] (41:08 - 41:45)

Till... Even when I entered here. See, there's a difference.

Why did I have stage fright? There's a sense of not feeling that confident in the beginning. But when I start performing, I start really being in the moment more.

Even my first ram show, I came back crying. My first photo shoot, I came back crying. Because I was so conscious in my first photo shoot that I knew that I was not giving my best and I was not performing my best.

And I could sense that the photographers also knew it was my first shoot. And that thing of needing to do well was not getting fulfilled.

[Speaker 2] (41:45 - 41:47)

So what changed? How are you like this now?

[Speaker 1] (41:47 - 42:07)

I think I gained confidence with work. While working. I think when you keep putting yourself in situations that you're scared of, at some point, you surpass that.

And at some point, you gain that confidence. Then you're like, hey, this is not that bad. And hey, I can do it.

So I feel like I have in a way taught myself confidence through...

[Speaker 2] (42:07 - 42:11)

So do you seek situations where you're uncomfortable? Do you seek them?

[Speaker 1] (42:11 - 42:13)

To some extent, at times.

[Speaker 2] (42:13 - 42:19)

Give me an example today. What is an uncomfortable situation for you? Don't say it now, please.

Something else.

[Speaker 1] (42:20 - 42:59)

No, this was not, honestly. But if I have to say... If I have to say today...

If I have to go globally somewhere on some stage and give a speech, I would be scared. I would be scared. I would prepare.

Because I'm that person who prepares. There have been many instances in terms of roles also. You know that I don't know how I'm going to do it.

I don't know how to approach the scene. That excites me. And that's one of the reasons why I say yes.

Because it also excites me. While it scares me.

[Speaker 2] (43:00 - 43:02)

So scary and exciting is the same emotion for you?

[Speaker 1] (43:02 - 43:09)

But it is the same emotion, you know? You feel the same. When you feel anxious and when you feel excited, it's actually the same emotion.

[Speaker 2] (43:09 - 43:10)

Personally and professionally?

[Speaker 1] (43:13 - 43:19)

Personally, no. Personally, if I'm feeling anxious and scared, it's not the same emotion as excited at all.

[Speaker 2] (43:20 - 43:29)

Work-wise. Do you feel anxious often? I'm trying to put you in a box.

Avoidant, attached or anxious, attached. Because you're like, flirting with both sides.

[Speaker 3] (43:31 - 43:35)

That's how I am. I don't know. I don't know.

[Speaker 2] (43:35 - 43:44)

How often do you feel anxious? Have you had a panic attack ever? No, that's what not.

Not yet. But do you get anxious often?

[Speaker 1] (43:45 - 43:55)

Anxious, I'll tell you. Unresolved issues with someone close. Gets me anxious.

Confrontation with that person. While I need to confront.

[Speaker 2] (43:56 - 43:57)

Do you run away from confrontation? No.

[Speaker 1] (43:58 - 44:05)

But I don't like if there's an issue with someone who I'm close to. I just feel like, or if I've let somebody down.

[Speaker 2] (44:05 - 44:11)

But you're comfortable confronting the person because you can't handle the awkwardness.

[Speaker 1] (44:11 - 44:37)

I'm comfortable confronting. But if I have let somebody down and I feel that I have let somebody down. Unknowingly, unwontingly, whatever.

And that person is upset. And these are very few people in my life. They're not anybody.

And everybody being upset is not gonna... Very few people who are like, who really matter. Like, then I feel a little anxious if I've not resolved that.

That gets me anxious.

[Speaker 2] (44:38 - 45:04)

Okay, so to get over stage fright, what might have helped? You inherently seek validation like all of us do in different forms. And you...

You like the reward curve. The variable reward curve, almost. When you do well and you don't do well is a very binary outcome.

And it has an appeal. It's like a slot machine, right? Sometimes you win and sometimes you don't win.

Is that fair?

[Speaker 1] (45:04 - 45:25)

Yeah, to some extent. See, I feel also because since childhood, it's been there that I need to do well. I need to get good marks.

I need to not even have... Why did you miss 3 marks out of 100? That too happened.

So that pressure of needing to do well has always been there.

[Speaker 2] (45:25 - 45:36)

What is under that? Why is it? Often, mothers and fathers Yeah.

are vicariously living their own dreams through their children.

[Speaker 1] (45:38 - 45:51)

I also feel like, you know, when you have your first child, you don't really know what to do, right? But you organically... There's no book that is like, you have to do this.

So you put in everything and all your energy.

[Speaker 2] (45:51 - 46:01)

See, but today is different for you. When you were growing up, when you were 5 years old, when you did something well, it was a compliment to your mother as much as it was a compliment to you.

[Speaker 3] (46:02 - 46:03)

Yeah, yeah, 100%.

[Speaker 2] (46:04 - 46:15)

So maybe that gave her something that she wanted in her own childhood and never got. And you also mentioned she wanted to learn singing, learn dancing, maybe be an actor, but she never had the opportunity.

[Speaker 1] (46:15 - 46:22)

Yeah, probably. See, it's not like with my sister, she's not done the same. Maybe a little less.

[Speaker 2] (46:22 - 46:23)

Because now she has you.

[Speaker 1] (46:23 - 46:57)

Maybe all the energy also in the first bond goes there and you overdo it. But the second bond, you're also a little exhausted. And it did.

My sister also used to get tests, isn't it? But I was the person who was obedient, who, I used to be a slow eater. If I'm not eating and I used to sometimes watch TV while eating, it took two hours to eat.

And she would be like, go out and eat at the dining table. My sister would go out and put the roti under the shelf and be like, it's done. I wouldn't do that.

It's also a personality difference.

[Speaker 2] (46:58 - 47:11)

Okay. What else helped? The college to acting transition.

What did you do right that others did not? I can't say about others for sure. Because everybody wants to be a heroine, hero.

[Speaker 1] (47:12 - 47:13)

See, I feel...

[Speaker 2] (47:13 - 47:24)

We live in a country where the three of you represent like demigod figures in three different industries. Everybody wants to be a cricketer, actor. I don't know how to put Badshah in a box because he does everything.

[Speaker 1] (47:26 - 47:26)

I don't play cricket.

[Speaker 2] (47:28 - 47:31)

Musician. But are you a composer, singer?

[Speaker 1] (47:33 - 47:33)

Rapper.

[Speaker 2] (47:34 - 47:41)

Rapper. All of them. All of it.

So I can't put a title to it, right? Yeah. What did you do differently?

[Speaker 1] (47:43 - 47:56)

See, I believe that there is a part which is dependent on your persistence and your hard work and your talent. And there is a part which is destiny. And I feel like it's always...

[Speaker 2] (47:56 - 47:58)

I don't want any of those answers. Give me another one.

[Speaker 1] (47:59 - 48:07)

What does this mean? I know you're not giving any marks that I'm wanting to pass here. No, this is the...

No, I don't know. I'm genuinely...

[Speaker 3] (48:07 - 48:07)

But this is a...

[Speaker 1] (48:07 - 48:19)

It's not like when I came here... See, obviously, I was also a little lost in Mumbai. I didn't know where to go, what to do, how to...

What do I do? Do I click? Honestly, the fact that I wanted to even come here has happened by chance.

[Speaker 2] (48:19 - 48:25)

See, your one ambition for this conversation is to help a 20-year-old girl become an actress. I agree.

[Speaker 3] (48:25 - 48:26)

I agree.

[Speaker 2] (48:26 - 48:29)

But hard work doesn't help to that end. Hard work, destiny... It does.

[Speaker 1] (48:30 - 48:31)

See, it is...

[Speaker 2] (48:31 - 48:32)

It is also destiny.

[Speaker 1] (48:32 - 48:33)

I'm not saying every person...

[Speaker 2] (48:33 - 49:07)

There might be somebody else who is more talented than me and is working harder. But doesn't have that opportunity in front of them. I'll give you a very contradicting view on this.

I feel like hard work has very little impact on the outcome of a certain thing. Hard work is generally something that we use to appease our own ego when our ego comes calling. As an explanation to why we failed or validation to why we succeeded.

Hard work as a by-product of the success I don't think has very big correlation.

[Speaker 3] (49:08 - 49:09)

No, I feel like...

[Speaker 2] (49:09 - 49:09)

Like your house...

[Speaker 3] (49:09 - 49:10)

Then you're damn lucky if you...

[Speaker 1] (49:10 - 49:12)

Or you're damn talented.

[Speaker 2] (49:12 - 49:16)

No, so the hard work is a prerequisite. It's not a defining factor.

[Speaker 1] (49:16 - 49:19)

Of course. Hard work in any profession is needed.

[Speaker 2] (49:20 - 49:22)

What is the alag in your alag tariqe ka hard work?

[Speaker 1] (49:22 - 49:49)

See, I also feel like the talent or the skill that you have is definitely important. I think with me I didn't really... I've not gone to theatre.

I've not done any sort of... I did when I came to Mumbai. I did a little bit of a home workshop with somebody to just keep my machine moving.

I'm a learner. I've always been. I think it is...

[Speaker 2] (49:49 - 49:51)

What do you mean by I'm a learner, I've always been?

[Speaker 1] (49:51 - 49:59)

Meaning I'm always... You know in the beginning I was told that She asks a lot of questions. She asks too many questions.

[Speaker 4] (49:59 - 49:59)

We have something in common.

[Speaker 1] (49:59 - 50:25)

Everyone knows that. I can see that. But she asks a lot of questions.

She asks a lot of questions. But I think to me it came from engineering also. The curiousness of knowing more.

I've always been that person. I think somewhere asking these questions on set How should I do this? You know, should I do this?

Is this girl like this? Is she coming from here? Is my understanding of evolving and growing?

[Speaker 2] (50:26 - 50:34)

Were you okay to ask? Absolute. Too okay to ask sometimes.

See, that one's interesting. Most people are shy to ask.

[Speaker 1] (50:34 - 51:01)

See, I feel like You know, it's funny because those people who used to say She asks a lot of questions. Firstly, if a woman is asking She asks a lot of questions. A guy is very, very involved.

He's asking so many questions. Look how involved he is. You know, that's also a thing.

You hear that. I've heard it. To the same people now saying What is the best thing about her?

You know, she asks questions. She wants to learn. So I think the perception also changes from where you are.

[Speaker 2] (51:02 - 51:07)

I think most people who don't ask don't ask for the insecurity of rejection.

[Speaker 1] (51:08 - 51:41)

And the insecurity of looking stupid. Sometimes. But I always say ask questions because I don't You have to keep learning and growing.

So yes, you can observe and learn. But sometimes if you have questions in your mind ask because that's the only way of getting answers. You used to go to school and ask questions?

I used to ask. I didn't understand anything. Until I don't understand I have a problem.

I have to understand. Doing math was just in certain subjects that you don't have to do anything You know. So science is all about logics.

[Speaker 2] (51:41 - 51:42)

Yeah. Mostly.

[Speaker 1] (51:42 - 51:45)

Chemistry sometimes can be a bit of math.

[Speaker 2] (51:45 - 51:48)

Give me more. Give me more like asking without shame.

[Speaker 1] (51:50 - 51:51)

Asking without shame.

[Speaker 2] (51:53 - 52:01)

That's how I summarized it. in the manner that you said. Asking without the insecurity of looking stupid.

[Speaker 1] (52:01 - 52:05)

See I feel like wanting to learn and coming from that Curiosity.

[Speaker 2] (52:05 - 52:06)

Yes.

[Speaker 1] (52:06 - 52:08)

Curiosity. Wanting to learn. Wanting to grow.

[Speaker 2] (52:09 - 52:19)

And being also okay with not knowing. But still Kriti, why you? Out of the 50 million young girls who want to be actresses why you?

[Speaker 1] (52:20 - 52:51)

Okay. I genuinely would also credit a bit of it to my luck. To my destiny that I got certain opportunities at certain points in my career.

Honestly, I didn't even know if I could act. I didn't even know I wanted to go for acting. I randomly somebody told me you're really tall you know you should try modeling.

And in my head I was like okay I can do it. To do it. Then I was like okay how do I start?

I need a portfolio. Then some I was like who should I get a portfolio from?

[Speaker 2] (52:51 - 52:55)

Is that how somebody should start? No this is Modeling get a portfolio.

[Speaker 1] (52:55 - 53:30)

This is how I figured my passion. You have to find your passion. I firstly feel people you know how in 3 Idiots they say bhed chaal mein chal rahe hain.

I don't know if you get that. Most people don't know their passion. They don't know what they really want to do.

I didn't know I went for engineering because I could. And I felt I like computer science. I don't know what an engineer does.

So you have to love what you do. You have to come from a place of passion firstly. I think is when you will really really do well.

So either you have to be really passionate about something or you have to be really good at something.

[Speaker 2] (53:31 - 53:42)

And you have to find that. Is there such a thing as passion? Psychology believes that you start telling yourself you're passionate at something when you realise you're better at something.

[Speaker 1] (53:42 - 53:45)

Of course. And then you get passionate about it.

[Speaker 2] (53:45 - 53:46)

Same logic for talent.

[Speaker 1] (53:47 - 54:24)

Yeah you get passionate about it. You have to So when I was doing a photo shoot I came back crying. When I was doing a ramp walk I came back crying.

But when I was doing a TV commercial in front of a moving camera I was nervous. But when I performed I was like hey you know I can do this. I think I'm good at it.

And I think I enjoy it. I like it. I enjoy it because I'm good at it.

And to recognise that in you to recognise your skill to recognise your skill and make it your passion Hmm. Or to recognise And then work hard on it. To get where you have to.

[Speaker 2] (54:26 - 54:47)

If I were to go play football and say I started playing football at age 10 and the other people I'm playing with are age 8 by virtue of age if I'm a little bit better at football than them will I start to feel I'm passionate about football and I'm talented at football?

[Speaker 1] (54:47 - 54:52)

You might feel that in the beginning but then the idea is to push yourself and go to the next level.

[Speaker 2] (54:53 - 54:54)

Where So is that a key?

[Speaker 1] (54:54 - 55:01)

Like try doing Try putting yourself in a situation which scares you a little bit and challenges you.

[Speaker 2] (55:01 - 55:09)

Come more prepared to your very first challenge so then you feel like you're innately better than the people around you and it becomes your passion?

[Speaker 1] (55:09 - 55:23)

Not necessarily. No? Not necessarily.

I had my first few auditions my first film audition was Student of the Year 1. I was horrible at it. Also to not give up after you fall.

[Speaker 4] (55:24 - 55:25)

Hmm.

[Speaker 1] (55:26 - 56:50)

I came back crying but I kept modelling. In fact my mom said that you know this field that you're wanting to go in requires a lot of like you need to be thick skinned and you need to take pressure. You know she used to give me examples of Priyanka Chopra and all these other big actors who are so confident and she knew that I was a shy kid and I'm not that confident and I'm coming back crying after one thing has not gone well.

So being protective as a mother she was like you know what like don't do it. You can't do it. There are a few more thick skinned people here.

And in my I still went for it. I still was like no I can do it. When they saw me on the screen for the

first time they were shocked because they had no idea I could act.

So even after you fall to sort of still have the courage to get up and give it another shot and then give it another shot. Till you become good at it. My first few auditions were really bad.

I kept working and learning and asking questions and figuring and I got better with every audition. Even in my films when I'm my first few films yeah as a newcomer I think if you're confident enough and you're expressive enough you get appreciated for just that and then you have to find the actor slowly.

[Speaker 2] (56:52 - 56:58)

Interesting. Should we leave Kriti college to later for a little bit later? Yes I'm tired.

[Speaker 1] (56:59 - 57:04)

I feel like I've only been talking. Nobody else is talking. Can we know these two people also?

[Speaker 2] (57:05 - 57:08)

Rahul next? Yeah. So tell us about yourself.

[Speaker 1] (57:10 - 57:18)

Okay let's start. Okay I grew up in a small town called Mangalore. Which is about 6-7 hours away from Mangalore.

[Speaker 2] (57:18 - 57:20)

Which is where I'm from as well.

[Speaker 1] (57:20 - 58:05)

Yeah we both are from there. I grew up I was there for the first 18 years of my life. My schooling happened there.

But originally we are from Mangalore. My mom and dad both are from Mangalore. And my dad got a really good job offer when I was born in Mangalore.

So we all moved there. My parents are also professors. I mean my dad my dad is a professor.

My mom was a What do they teach? My dad taught geology. A professor in geology.

And my mom was a lecturer in Indian history.

[Speaker 3] (58:05 - 58:06)

Wow.

[Speaker 1] (58:06 - 59:27)

So I also come from like family that were like both teachers. Grew up in this very small town. I lived actually an hour away from Mangalore.

We lived my dad was in a engineering college. He taught there. So we used to live in the campus.

It was a massive campus. So campus you know my schooling was in the campus just for the faculty there used to be a school which later on became open to other like public around the smaller smaller cities and towns there. So I grew up there and my dad tells me that I picked up the bat when I was two and a half, three years old.

Like the plastic bat. And I used to run around the house all day playing cricket and I'd make him throw balls at me nonstop. So yeah, my love for cricket started then.

So I was a decent student. Not 90s and stuff but around that 80, 90 mark. I'd always be there and I always loved sport.

In school I played every sport that my school took part in. Be it football, volleyball, swimming, athletics. We didn't have a cricket team.

[Speaker 2] (59:27 - 59:30)

So does that help playing different sports?

[Speaker 1] (59:30 - 1:00:07)

I think so. Now I realize that if you play football you get better at cricket. No, just playing different sport helped me be more athletic.

Like my body developed really well, which later on helped me when I chose one sport. Then I was good at everything. There's so many players that I've played with who've only played cricket all along.

And you can see that their athletic ability is not as much as someone else who's played multiple sports growing up. So yeah, I played a lot of sport and around 10 or 11 is when I...

[Speaker 2] (1:00:08 - 1:00:23)

Would you go to the extent of saying if you only play cricket all your life for 10 hours a day or 6 hours a day or whatever, it wouldn't work out as well for you at cricket as playing 3 hours of cricket, 1 hour of football, 1 hour of tennis?

[Speaker 1] (1:00:23 - 1:00:59)

No, I'm not saying that. I'm just saying like your athletic ability like will be different. Like cricket requires like your body to move a certain way and like certain muscle groups are getting strong but it's not an...

You're not developing overall like your ability of your body. So playing football requires a different level of fitness. Playing volleyball requires a different level of fitness.

Swimming requires something different. And I grew up by the beach like 100 meters away from my house was the beach. Which beach?

The Suratkal beach.

[Speaker 4] (1:00:59 - 1:01:00)

Near the college?

[Speaker 1] (1:01:00 - 1:02:53)

Yeah, college. We lived in the campus. So we got out and the beach was right there.

So I'd play a lot of sport in school and my day would finish in the beach. On the beach, we'd play some football and then jump into the sea, swim for an hour, come back and then study for an hour. Yeah, that was my daily routine.

And then when I reached about I think eight by seven, eight, I was really like obsessed with cricket. I wanted to play cricket and I kept telling my father put me in a summer camp. I want to go and like, you know, because all my friends who were not as good at cricket, when we play gully cricket, you know, you realize whether you're good or you're not good.

So I was very good and I was like, dad, I want to go there because all my friends are going there. And at that age, you're like, you know, he's going for coaching, cricket coaching. You get that cool quotient when you go somewhere else, you leave that campus and you go away into the bigger city or like you do something different.

You get that. So I want to do this because I'm good. Just put me there, put me there.

It happened for two, three years. My dad just felt like I was too young and I wasn't a big kid. I was a tiny little skinny kid.

So he's like, no, you won't be able to play cricket or I don't know what his reasons were. He didn't send me till I was 11. And then when I was 11, he put me into a cricket, cricket camp.

And immediately from week one, like there was a summer camp where all the kids come in and

the same academy had, I mean, the same place had an academy where there are players who were picked as, you know, as their talent scouts who pick you from these summer camps and say, OK, he's good. We can work on him. And you get picked into the academy where the coaching is better and you're with better cricketers.

The standard is better.

[Speaker 2] (1:02:53 - 1:02:58)

So is that how somebody gets into something like an IPL today? You go through one coaching camp to another.

[Speaker 1] (1:02:58 - 1:03:01)

No, no, I feel you've gone very, very far ahead.

[Speaker 2] (1:03:01 - 1:03:02)

So where does this lead to?

[Speaker 1] (1:03:02 - 1:03:18)

One smaller coaching camp, bigger coaching camp, then you get your like basic like cricket coaching and you have the talent, but there's a technical side to cricket, which you need to learn Does talent make such a big difference in cricket?

[Speaker 2] (1:03:18 - 1:03:21)

Are you born better than another person? Of course, I think so.

[Speaker 1] (1:03:21 - 1:03:47)

I think so. Your ability to judge what speed the ball is coming at and your ability to judge how much it will bounce from a certain area, how much it will move, which direction and your hand-eye coordination and all of that is like, you know, that's the difference. I feel like without trying to be too arrogant about it, that's a difference between someone who makes it to the higher level and someone who doesn't make it to the higher level.

[Speaker 2] (1:03:47 - 1:03:51)

What is it? Is it visual ability? Is it hand-eye coordination?

[Speaker 1] (1:03:52 - 1:04:08)

It's all of it, right? Your ability to firstly see the ball properly and then judge how fast it's coming, how much it's going to bounce and also react to that ball and like hit the ball like where you want

it to. So there's a lot of stuff.

[Speaker 2] (1:04:08 - 1:04:13)

Very tangible things these sound like. Like somebody should be able to measure it, no? Yeah, so you can do that.

You might have…

[Speaker 1] (1:04:13 - 1:05:08)

Is that something that you can acquire? Like can you not be that good at it and then become really good at it? But there are certain things that you can't get better at.

Like if you don't have hand-eye coordination and this is my version. I might be very wrong. Yeah.

If your hand-eye coordination is not great, then you can pick up any sport and you will not be as good and it'll only frustrate you more and more over time that, shit, I'm working so hard. Why am I not doing? And a lot of like athletes stop doing whatever sport because of that.

Because you reach a certain stage where you realize, okay, I'm not that good and how much more can I keep losing? Because at the end of the day, sport is, you know, you're competing with someone else and you have to win to keep going up the ladder and go to the next stage. So at every stage, you will have these like, you know, reminders or you'll get to know like whether you're good or not.

[Speaker 2] (1:05:08 - 1:05:14)

So, yeah, so… Feel free to ask questions, okay? Conversation between all of us.

Yeah, yeah. I'm sure you're also curious, how is cricket like?

[Speaker 1] (1:05:15 - 1:05:48)

Bro, I mean, this hand-eye coordination, I mean, as far as I understand, it's a natural ability. I mean, someone sees the ball slow, someone sees it fast. But aren't there ways to practice and, you know, enhance the ability?

I'm sure there are. There will be such facilities now, but the natural, like, I know this might not like convince your mind because you think so deeply, but there are like some abilities that you're gifted with that can't be taught, right? I believe this.

[Speaker 2] (1:05:48 - 1:05:50)

So nature versus nurture, you're on the side of nature.

[Speaker 1] (1:05:50 - 1:06:04)

Yeah, I'm on the side of nature completely. At least when it comes to cricket. At least when it comes to sport.

Well, you know, what are you saying about like having something that you're born with, certain skills, certain talent? I think it's true for… Everybody.

[Speaker 3] (1:06:04 - 1:06:05)

Every creative field.

[Speaker 1] (1:06:05 - 1:06:18)

When she was talking, I was like, like, I know why she can't explain because there is no explanation, you know, like she was, she's like, how was you asked her, not everybody can act is a thing. Not everybody can sing.

[Speaker 2] (1:06:23 - 1:06:33)

I'll tell you where I'm coming from. In my world, let's say broadly, I'm in the world of finance. There is no such thing as talent.

As? Talent.

[Speaker 1] (1:06:34 - 1:07:32)

And I don't feel the analytic ability in general. Like, okay, I'm saying I used to not like math because I used to be not good at it, but I became good at it, but it's not with everyone. Not everyone will become great at math.

It's something to do with how you process, you know, sometimes some people are just born with it and some people are not. You, if you have a little bit of a talent, you can groom it. But if it's not there at all, sometimes you just can't.

If you take a math example, math is only like mental. Like you can mug it or like practice it every day and it'll happen. But like acting, you can, you can, You can't explain.

You can do your lines and you can know the whole, whole thing. But when you have to think, speak, act, express, like when the whole body had to, has to coordinate together, that is something that you can't.

[Speaker 2] (1:07:32 - 1:07:37)

When I hear Bollywood is not working, right? Like in Bombay, I have one or two friends who are

in your industry.

[Speaker 1] (1:07:37 - 1:07:38)

You still hear that?

[Speaker 3] (1:07:40 - 1:07:40)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:07:40 - 1:07:40)

What?

[Speaker 3] (1:07:41 - 1:07:43)

I think it's doing great now.

[Speaker 2] (1:07:43 - 1:07:44)

No, it's not.

[Speaker 3] (1:07:44 - 1:07:44)

Yeah, yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:07:44 - 1:07:54)

I don't think so. Personally, I don't think so. And they don't seem to think so.

And when they tell me Bollywood is not working, my go-to... Why is it not working though?

[Speaker 4] (1:07:54 - 1:07:55)

Yeah, who said?

[Speaker 2] (1:07:56 - 1:08:39)

And when, when you say it's not working, what do you mean it's not working? Touchwood, my last two films did pretty well. I'll give you an example.

Like, there's a couple of companies I'm a small part of. And let's say, occupancy rates in multiplexes are lower than where they were five years ago. It's harder for a multiplex to make money.

It's harder for talent in Bollywood to make as much money as they did a couple of years ago. It's harder for the number of people that Bollywood used to once employ for the same number of

people to be employed today. The odds of the movie succeeding may have been X percentage.

Today, they're lower than X percentage.

[Speaker 1] (1:08:39 - 1:08:41)

Also because there are many more number of films also getting made.

[Speaker 2] (1:08:41 - 1:08:51)

So, it's not working as good as it used to be. Yeah, from a very statistical standpoint, I think it's become more democratic. Also less profitable, right?

[Speaker 1] (1:08:53 - 1:09:35)

Profitable is different but... You see, I think the expectation of the profit, what used to be earlier, 100 CR done, wow, 100 CR done, used to be a big deal. Now 100 CR is also not a big deal.

So, I feel like the expectation has gone somewhere else also. There was a phase where it was not. But I feel like theatres are back and how now?

So, I think there was a phase where what you learnt has progressed and what you didn't learn will remain. This phase was when Bollywood was actually not working. I mean, everyone could see it was not working.

Factually, it wasn't working. Statistically, too. After that, I think a lot of people had to change.

And the one who changed was surviving.

[Speaker 2] (1:09:37 - 1:09:55)

But I think the word, if I had to describe it with the word that you used, I would say it's surviving. It's not thriving today. I mean, my choice of word was wrong.

Thriving, too. But anyways, there was a... You were saying something else, yeah.

[Speaker 4] (1:09:55 - 1:09:56)

Sorry, I got a little...

[Speaker 2] (1:09:58 - 1:10:51)

No, no. It's good to be touchy about the industry you belong to. You talk about the stock market.

I'll defend it. Yeah, so when I think of Bollywood and when I hear people from that industry say it's not working, the place where my brain goes to is why is no one utilizing data almost like that Moneyball book in a manner where you get data of what scene gave what reaction in the

audience, start measuring those reactions, which cast gets what kind of an audience to buy a ticket, what trigger event is working. And there's so much data that one can collate for like 10, 20, 30, 50 years and be more data oriented in planning a project versus emotion oriented as how the incumbent players work.

I was just making that.

[Speaker 1] (1:10:52 - 1:13:06)

No, but I'll tell you like my response to that. Data is being used a lot in cricket as well. It's very easy to say see what player from over 10 to 15 scores the most runs, pick him in the team.

You know, it's as easy as that. And people have done that. Like you watch the IPL and the way the IPL works with a lot of like owners coming from the background that they come from, from the business background.

I'm sure everything works based on data and like their research. They do a lot of research and we pick teams based on that. But that doesn't guarantee that you're going to win every game of cricket.

You might get the best players based on data, but they might have a horrible year. Like, you know, if like 11 players, each one has one bad day out of the 14 games that we play, you've lost the whole season. So there are certain things that are not in your control.

Certain, you can use certain things, but nothing, at least in sport guarantees better performance better performance or success. It's not that you do this and your success rate is going to go up. There is no formula like that.

And I think it's the same with, with them. Like, you know. Exactly.

I think creative field. So Spotify has given us a lot of data in music, you know, and a lot of big labels have data analysts. That this certain genre of music works this much.

At this time, there will be a drop. At this time, there will be a build up. But eventually, and that is also one of the reasons why AI might not be I don't think it will be successful.

But eventually of creating art and for a consumer or for an audience to discover it the way they discover it is what it is all about. That beauty can't be quantized. And that beauty film or music.

I mean, I think or cricket.

[Speaker 2] (1:13:07 - 1:13:19)

I hope so. Yeah, it is. But coming back to Rahul.

So you were sent to or you asked to go to cricket coaching when you were seven.

[Speaker 1] (1:13:20 - 1:13:21)

Eleven. Eleven.

[Speaker 2] (1:13:21 - 1:13:22)

Made a crazy big difference.

[Speaker 1] (1:13:24 - 1:14:03)

It did because it was something that I was wanting to do since I was seven, eight years old. And my dad wouldn't just send me. I was like, you know, then you get like frustrated at that age.

You're like, everyone's going. All my friends are going. And it's during the summer where you don't have school.

Like you're not doing anything. I'm anyways playing cricket all day in the gully. I might as well go and like get proper coaching.

And why don't you? So after a point, yeah, when he sent finally, I was really happy that, OK, so finally I've come come to a place where I've always wanted to come. And cricket made me gave me some sort of like joy and happiness.

[Speaker 2] (1:14:03 - 1:14:14)

And was having parents in academia a boon or a bane? Would it have been different if you were Kapil Dev's son, for example? No, I don't think so.

[Speaker 1] (1:14:15 - 1:15:13)

At least in cricket, I don't think there's your legacy or where you come from, what your parents did really matter that much. But were they supportive like from the beginning? They were supportive.

My parents, like my dad played a little bit of cricket in his time for his college and university and all that. He played cricket and his parents didn't let him play more. So he him being the son, one of, I think, seven children.

So he had to, you know, give it up, give up and like pursue like whatever he had to do back then. So he was never against it. But they were very strict about education as well.

The minute we see that your grades are dropping, we will pull you out of cricket. We let you pursue your dreams and do whatever you want. But this is our condition.

You do this, then we'll support you. We have no problem.

[Speaker 3] (1:15:13 - 1:15:14)

This is so similar.

[Speaker 1] (1:15:14 - 1:15:25)

Yeah, so I think it is very similar in most families. Yeah, like I gave GMAT entrance exam while I was trying for films. Yeah, you're born, you go to school, you do your engineering and then you become what you want.

Correct.

[Speaker 2] (1:15:26 - 1:15:50)

Is it the same for you as well, Pacha? How do I address you? Badshah is the name?

Aditya. I did not know this. I like that name.

Aditya is nice. Yeah, I like that. I feel like so often kids take the personalities of the names they're given.

[Speaker 4] (1:15:51 - 1:15:51)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:15:53 - 1:16:08)

Aditya in my mind appears to be like this bright, fair, good looking, studious boy from North India. I blush. I think so.

Rahul is a very romantic name.

[Speaker 1] (1:16:08 - 1:16:11)

That has made him romantic.

[Speaker 2] (1:16:11 - 1:16:13)

But KL Rahul sounds like a cricketer.

[Speaker 1] (1:16:13 - 1:16:24)

By the way, my dad's name is Rahul. No, it's done now. But KL Rahul sounds like either a South hero.

KL Rahul, the angry superstar or whatever it is. Or a cricketer like you.

[Speaker 2] (1:16:24 - 1:16:28)

In South India, we put the name before the name. Dad's name. City's name as well.

[Speaker 1] (1:16:29 - 1:16:39)

Village. K is the name of the village. Then followed by...

I haven't met a single person from Mangalore whom I didn't like.

[Speaker 2] (1:16:39 - 1:16:45)

Bangalore or Mangalore? Mangalore. We both have met.

Like I... You're making up for coming late now.

[Speaker 1] (1:16:45 - 1:16:52)

This is what you should have said when you just entered. But yeah, sorry. It's a very small town.

[Speaker 4] (1:16:53 - 1:16:55)

Mine is Udhyavar.

[Speaker 1] (1:16:55 - 1:17:06)

Yeah, even smaller. So we just went yesterday. In fact, on Sunday, me, Atiya and Ahaan went to Mangalore.

We wanted to visit some temples which I do every year.

[Speaker 2] (1:17:06 - 1:17:11)

Can I ask you three celebrities a controversial question? I was about to ask the same.

[Speaker 1] (1:17:12 - 1:17:12)

Are you spiritual?

[Speaker 2] (1:17:12 - 1:17:13)

Go ahead.

[Speaker 1] (1:17:13 - 1:17:15)

Are you religious? Do you believe in God?

[Speaker 2] (1:17:15 - 1:17:43)

When you guys go to a temple and there are 500 people waiting in line and you break the line and go into the front of the temple by virtue of partly necessity, partly whatever because you know, people will take pictures and all of that. What does that act... What is the summary of that act inside of your head?

I've never done that. I'm in line.

[Speaker 1] (1:17:44 - 1:18:20)

I have done that. But I... Yeah, honestly, that's why what he's saying, I connect to it that it doesn't give you that same feeling.

But in Mumbai or in India, if I want to go to a temple, you know, it just becomes a little difficult if I don't do that. So if it comes to my mind, they say, if it comes to your mind, you should go. So if it comes to your mind, you should go.

There is a part that feels like A, it's not fair but can I do anything about it? I'm going to stand in that line. OK, if there's going to be no pictures and nobody is going to do anything about it.

[Speaker 2] (1:18:21 - 1:18:25)

What is religion for you guys? Let's start with Rahul. Why are you religious?

[Speaker 1] (1:18:26 - 1:18:35)

Again, I'll just go back to saying that's you see and learn certain things when you grow up. And my parents were very religious. I saw them pray.

[Speaker 2] (1:18:35 - 1:18:36)

What if you were born in a box?

[Speaker 1] (1:18:38 - 1:19:26)

It would be very different. Of course, it would be very different. You are like you said, you are who you are today from the things that you've learned growing up.

Your experiences, what you watched and you always have someone you look up to. And as kids, it's generally your parents and what my parents did and what I saw. That's what I learned.

And as I grew, obviously, like my relationship with God has changed over time. My parents worship, let's say Shivji and that's what we, that's what I was taught. But then as I grew up, like my calling was something else.

I might want to go to a Hanuman Mandir or things like that. So then my connection changed.

What do you mean by calling?

If you change from... You find your own faith and beliefs.

[Speaker 2] (1:19:26 - 1:19:38)

Yeah, it's just, I mean, yeah. Is there a different interpretation of the faith that you're resonating with? When you say you went from a particular temple to another kind of temple, what do you mean by calling?

What changed?

[Speaker 1] (1:19:40 - 1:20:16)

As you grew, as I learned or as I read more about the Hindu religion, our books, and then, you know, at whatever stage you are in, in your life, you feel like, okay, this is the God that, you know, there are gods, right? Like for wisdom, you have a God, for strength, you have a God, for peace and happiness, for everything. There's different gods in our culture, which is great.

So like each stage when I felt like this is what I'm searching, let's say peace is what I'm searching. I'll go to like, go to a Mandir that I feel like can give me that.

[Speaker 2] (1:20:16 - 1:20:19)

Do you go more often to seek forgiveness or say thank you?

[Speaker 1] (1:20:20 - 1:21:11)

Nothing, neither, neither. I just like to go and sit. And like I said, I just feel like it reminds me of a time where, you know, I had nothing and I could just, you know, everything that I've gotten from there on is a blessing and a gift.

So I just go there to sit and remember that at times I had nothing and I should be grateful for everything that I have now, which is very difficult in the line of work we are. We keep forgetting like how much we have achieved and we only keep looking at our failures and, you know, how much more you need to achieve. But sometimes it's good to just sit and look back and think and just, you know, say your thanks and say your peace and just go back to those days where you had nothing.

So I like that, that 10, 15 minutes.

[Speaker 2] (1:21:11 - 1:21:20)

Is the act of reminding yourself of how far you've come. Is that the high when you're at a temple?

[Speaker 1] (1:21:22 - 1:21:38)

It's not a high, but I feel like it's necessary to remind yourself sometimes of what you're here for, what your goal was when you set out, when I set out to be a cricketer or when I wanted to achieve my dream.

[Speaker 2] (1:21:38 - 1:21:40)

But why is it necessary to remind yourself?

[Speaker 1] (1:21:41 - 1:21:57)

I just like, I just like having that balance and not getting too far ahead. You know, sometimes you feel like, oh, I've played cricket for 10 years. Now I should be doing this or I should get into a team like very easily or I should get my runs and all of that.

[Speaker 2] (1:21:57 - 1:22:27)

So in your journey of garnering power, power, think of it as an embellishment or a euphemism of any other word, but you're on step one, you go to two, you go to three, you go to four, you go to five. At five, when you go to a temple and remind yourself of three, are you hedging your bets against the future event of six or seven or whichever way that might go?

[Speaker 1] (1:22:29 - 1:22:36)

All I'm trying to do is not worry about the six and seven. I want to remind...

[Speaker 2] (1:22:36 - 1:22:37)

It appeases that anxiety.

[Speaker 1] (1:22:38 - 1:23:38)

Yeah. Yeah. It does that.

And then you just like, I don't like having or I don't like going onto a cricket ground wanting to achieve anything. It's something that gave me joy as a kid. And that's why I started playing the sport.

So I wanted to remain as much as possible just about that, about having fun, about, you know, it also has a lot to do with, you know, I was good at cricket. Other things maybe I was not so good at. So I chose this.

So I just want to, like, remind myself that, OK, six and seven is, or, you know, getting higher is a process that will happen. But don't be desperate about it or don't go searching for something higher than where you already are. And I've done that.

I've done that in my life. And I feel like being at five, like he said, if you're at five and you think of three, like, aren't you pushing yourself back? But at times I've tried to...

[Speaker 3] (1:23:38 - 1:23:38)

It calms you.

[Speaker 1] (1:23:38 - 1:24:33)

When I'm at five and I've tried to go to ten and I've gone to zero, you know, so that for me, that has happened a couple of times. So I recognize that it's a pattern that every time I try to overachieve or every time I try to, you know, look too far ahead, I miss what's under me. And then I fall down so far that I have to start all over again.

So for me, it's nice to just remind myself that, like, where you are is good enough and be happy with that. And do that for long enough. And then you'll realize then you'll slowly go to number six or then be happy with number six for long enough and keep doing that.

Then you'll achieve seven. It's a slow process. And I'm OK with that.

Every time I've tried to, like, get that quickly, life somewhere in some strange way has taught me that's not the right way for me. It might be different for other people.

[Speaker 2] (1:24:34 - 1:24:47)

So that sounds like a very interesting hack. If I were to be a cricketer, if I go onto the ground not worrying about the outcome, do I tend to play better? Yeah, definitely.

[Speaker 1] (1:24:47 - 1:26:39)

Again, it's individual. For a lot of people, it's not like that. A lot of people like to, you know, some people like to get angry and some people like to get into fights and that gets them going.

And that's when they've performed at their best. But for me, that hasn't worked. For me, what works is just to be, like I said, just to walk into the ground knowing that either things can happen, but you might fail, you might succeed.

But yeah, just that unknown is good and just keeps my foot on the ground. And it doesn't make me anxious about anything. But can you ever actually put that pressure away of the performance?

As much as you can. Is it possible to put it away? Not completely, but again, if you think back, at least when I think back, all my good performances have come when I'm in that type of mindset.

And then I'm always searching or like trying to push myself to get in that mindset, but it's not

easy. If I've not played well in two or three games, And the pressure is more. Yeah, pressure is more.

But then I immediately sit back and think, but if you put yourself under pressure, you're definitely not going to perform in the fourth game. So there's no point. That is the logical reasoning you're giving your own mind from the patterns that you've seen in your life.

But your body will not accept that. Your body still wants to feel the pressure when you go. It's a constant battle mentally, you know.

But as much as possible, I try to take that pressure out of myself. I feel like I create that pressure, nobody else. If I perform well or don't perform well, nothing in the country is changing.

When you start performing well on the pitch on that day, it gives you that confidence and then you would, I'm assuming, do better.

[Speaker 2] (1:26:40 - 1:26:56)

How do you deal with trolling? Is it tough? Like I know Rahul as a shy, quiet guy.

By the way, I adore his father-in-law, who whenever I see him takes me to the gym and trains me.

[Speaker 1] (1:26:57 - 1:26:58)

The besties in the building.

[Speaker 2] (1:26:59 - 1:27:26)

And he tells me how my form is wrong with every workout I do and how my breathing is wrong and everything is wrong. But he helps a lot. But you come from a very family mold.

You know, I was at their house having dinner yesterday, day before yesterday. Day before, yeah. Day before yesterday.

And they're very like a family unit. Does that help when the world is going against you? How do you deal with trolling overall?

[Speaker 1] (1:27:26 - 1:27:50)

I used to be good with trolling. I didn't care. But I feel like I was much younger back then.

And you know, in your 20s, I really didn't, for no better word, didn't give a s**t. And then I think a couple of years back, I was, you know, I think I was exposed to a lot of trolling. If I sat, I got trolled.

If I stood, I got trolled. If I…

[Speaker 2] (1:27:50 - 1:27:53)

After that interview? The bigger you get, the more trolled you were.

[Speaker 1] (1:27:53 - 1:29:10)

No, the interview was… It was a… That was a different world altogether.

That changed me. That definitely changed me. I went…

You know, I… Like you said, I was a very shy, soft-spoken boy growing up. And then I played for India.

And for the next three, four years, I did become very confident. And you know, I was… I had no problem like being in a huge group of people.

I would talk and I… You know, you… People would know that I've been in a room of like a hundred people.

They would know. Because I would talk to everybody and all of that. And that interview happened.

But now you don't? Now I don't. Because that interview, like, you know, and this…

Scarred you? Scarred me massively. I mean, there was, you know, getting suspended from…

Your vocation? From the team. And I've never been suspended in school.

I've never been punished in school. I've… I mean, I've never had to know how to handle it.

I was always… I was always… Okay, I was…

You know, I did like mischievous things in school and everything. But nothing to get me expelled from school or nothing to say that, you know, my parents have come and like, you know, I've had complaints.

[Speaker 2] (1:29:10 - 1:29:15)

And people innately like watching people in positions of power fail.

[Speaker 1] (1:29:15 - 1:29:17)

And fall. That was my first…

[Speaker 2] (1:29:17 - 1:29:19)

Like, innately, we all enjoy it. Like, people enjoy it.

[Speaker 1] (1:29:20 - 1:29:20)

Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (1:29:20 - 1:29:22)

Don't count me in. No, I'm not counting…

[Speaker 1] (1:29:22 - 1:29:27)

Not when you've become one of them. Then you realize how how bad it is.

[Speaker 2] (1:29:27 - 1:29:29)

But when you have not. Because that group is so tiny, right?

[Speaker 1] (1:29:30 - 1:29:30)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:29:30 - 1:29:41)

For most people in society, they call it what? Schadenfreude. Whenever you see pain in somebody who's at an elevation higher than you, there's something in your psychology that enjoys it.

[Speaker 1] (1:29:42 - 1:30:42)

You know, it's not so much about enjoying but it just becomes an interesting thing to talk about. I don't think it's just that. I think you enjoy it.

They really enjoy it. They enjoy it. They root for you to fall down.

The same people root for you to come back up. That's the strange thing. It's also the anti-establishment mentality.

You know, once you become too big, you become a sort of establishment. And then they want you to fall. And it happens in a lot of developing natures.

But everything is short-lived. That's what I've realized. In our world, at least everything there's a beautiful thing.

I think it was a… I think it's a cycle, brother. Like, first they support you when you're the underdog.

Then you become too big. Then they want you to fall. And then you have to outlive them in order for you to become a legend.

For example, Shah Rukh Khan. Like, someone like a Shah Rukh Khan. Someone like a Dhrijit Bhaji.

They support you. They want you to fail. And then you just have to do your work.

Which is the challenge.

[Speaker 3] (1:30:42 - 1:30:45)

What do you mean they want you to fail? I don't know. I just find that so negative.

[Speaker 1] (1:30:46 - 1:30:47)

But it is the world we live in.

[Speaker 3] (1:30:48 - 1:30:48)

Exactly.

[Speaker 1] (1:30:48 - 1:31:09)

They enjoy it. Did you see? Did you see?

A new film came out. Look at what's happening with Akshay Bhaji. It's…

I mean, I'm… I'm not like saying this in a… as a judgment to how people are.

But like, it is what it is. Like, it's okay. And I don't judge them for wanting…

[Speaker 3] (1:31:09 - 1:31:10)

Negativity.

[Speaker 1] (1:31:10 - 1:31:11)

Someone wants all the social media.

[Speaker 3] (1:31:11 - 1:31:12)

No, but it is like that, brother.

[Speaker 1] (1:31:12 - 1:31:20)

I've realized that. Like, it is easier for me to be more at peace. When I don't give other people the power.

[Speaker 3] (1:31:21 - 1:31:22)

Power, obviously. But it's hard to not.

[Speaker 1] (1:31:22 - 1:32:21)

You're absolutely right. Yeah, it's hard not to. But like, at least you have this…

But ignorance is bliss in some ways when it comes to this. It is. Like, for me also, I kind of like…

What difference does it make if you don't know? It's all important. I feel like in many ways, all of us will have…

We would have created this space for ourselves where we want to keep escaping and go back to that place where we feel like, okay, ignorance will be found here. Bliss will be found here. Like, I have…

I love going back to Bangalore. I have my friends who… We all played cricket together and grew up together.

So, I love going back there. And for two days also is like, you know, it's best. Like, I don't want…

I just feel like there's nothing enters that room. No trolling. No success.

Nothing. It's just like… Just four or five boys sitting and chilling.

But how many days can you stay there? You can't. No, right?

But at least when you go there and you come out, it feels like your battery is recharged and you have enough battery to last the next two months. So…

[Speaker 2] (1:32:21 - 1:32:26)

Did you try this? I think it's some kind of edamame. Wow, you just flipped it.

[Speaker 1] (1:32:31 - 1:32:32)

I'll take that.

[Speaker 4] (1:32:32 - 1:32:33)

I'll have this.

[Speaker 1] (1:32:35 - 1:33:01)

So, Nik, that's what I've done with trolling now in the last year and a half. Because like, I think a couple of years ago, it was quite rough. So, then I…

For the last one and a half years, I've gotten off Instagram completely. You know, I'll still go post,

do my things, and then get out of that place as quickly as I can. I know it's just, we've all become so…

[Speaker 3] (1:33:03 - 1:33:03)

Addicted, yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:33:04 - 1:33:18)

Addicted and synced and tuned to just, you know, the first thing you open your phone, you'll go to Instagram directly. So, that has helped me a little bit with dealing with trolling. It's like, if you don't know, what are you trying to deal with?

[Speaker 2] (1:33:18 - 1:33:22)

Great advice to young people, right? Get off social media. Absolutely.

[Speaker 1] (1:33:23 - 1:33:24)

I wouldn't say get off.

[Speaker 2] (1:33:24 - 1:33:24)

Get off, no.

[Speaker 1] (1:33:24 - 1:33:27)

It's also, I mean, sometimes it's needed.

[Speaker 2] (1:33:27 - 1:33:28)

Post and get off.

[Speaker 1] (1:33:29 - 1:33:39)

No, have consumed… Just don't… Go too deep into everything.

Don't make social media the priority. It's not like, I got validation on social media.

[Speaker 2] (1:33:39 - 1:33:56)

I don't need comments under a reel or a post or whatever. I don't read comments. Give us some other tips, Rahul.

What can help a young person make it like you did in your industry? Something that is not obvious. Um…

[Speaker 1] (1:33:56 - 1:36:23)

Basically, don't say hard work. No, I know. When he asked you that question, I was already thinking, what else can I say?

What else can I say? The answer is there. Yeah, exactly.

But the honest truth is just… Yeah. Honest truth is just that.

But also, I get what you're saying. That, you know, I had the same view that someone who started playing cricket with me at the age of 11, who also played state cricket and we were all at the same level. And probably I've seen many of them who are much more talented than I was.

Much more fitter than I was. But like, you know, I could make that climb and they couldn't. Like, so what is the…

I asked myself this question. What is it that I did that they couldn't do? But I just think the ability to be your own team.

In the sense, you're fighting a lot of battles. And if you're strong enough to be able to fight those battles all by yourself and alone, not having to lean on anybody. If you have that ability, that somewhere helps you, you know, go a little bit longer.

With the other things, obviously, with your self-belief, hard work and also just being real about how good you are. Like Kriti said, for so many people, they don't know till they're 25, 26 what their passion is or what their dream is, what do they want to do. I'm lucky that I've, you know, since as long as I can think, I only had one dream that was to become a cricketer.

Yeah, I was about to say, you're so lucky, Unnu. Yeah, I do. I know I'm very lucky.

I'm very grateful for that. I never had plan B and I never had to think about a plan B. I had one plan and I was lucky enough that, you know, I was blessed again.

That's probably the reason why I keep going back to temples and keep, you know, saying my thank you to the gods is because, you know, there's something that's not, it's hard to explain why another person couldn't make it and why I could make it. And that's the story with most of the players on the team. Um, yeah, so…

[Speaker 2] (1:36:23 - 1:36:48)

Does interpersonal relationship, relationships make a big difference? I feel like I put a huge weightage on niceness. I end up working with people who are nice because it makes a big difference to me, the overall attitude of my vicinity, the people I choose to work with.

Is it like that in cricket or in the movies?

[Speaker 1] (1:36:48 - 1:36:56)

But you can choose it outside of your work. In your work, you don't get to choose who you're surrounded with. Right?

And I can't, I can't…

[Speaker 2] (1:36:56 - 1:36:58)

But can they choose you by virtue of niceness?

[Speaker 1] (1:36:58 - 1:37:10)

In my work, I get to choose who I'm immediately surrounded with. That's what I'm saying, but outside of work. Outside of that, who I'm working with, obviously not.

Yeah, you can't. So, I mean, your, I guess your relationship with…

[Speaker 2] (1:37:13 - 1:37:17)

The odds of you getting picked or hired if you're a nicer guy or known to be?

[Speaker 1] (1:37:17 - 1:37:20)

No, no, no. That has no, like, at least in sport… It has no bearing in sport?

Nothing. Zero. Zero.

[Speaker 2] (1:37:21 - 1:37:28)

I could be like, I want to be in the cricket team, but I'm a d**k. I'm arrogant, I'm like… As long as you're good at what you do.

[Speaker 1] (1:37:28 - 1:37:36)

You can be all of those things and if you're scoring, scoring hundreds every game, there's nobody to stop you from being picked and yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:37:39 - 1:38:04)

So, if you had to draw a map, the path of least resistance, if I'm a 15-year-old, moderately talented wannabe cricketer, how do I make it to a team that is relevant? What path should I take? After all your learnings today?

Again, I mean… Which coaching camp should I go to? Should I try and get into an IPL team?

Should I…

[Speaker 1] (1:38:06 - 1:38:29)

See, again, like, you can have all of these dreams, but if you've not performed from… If you're a 15-year-old guy, let's say you aim to play at the IPL level by 20 or 21. If in those 6-7 years, if you've not even gone on to play for your state, if from state cricket, you've not gone on to play…

[Speaker 2] (1:38:29 - 1:38:31)

Is that the first step? Get into state team?

[Speaker 1] (1:38:31 - 1:38:38)

No, the first step is getting into your school. If your school has a cricket team or your academy has an academy team.

[Speaker 2] (1:38:38 - 1:38:40)

So, which school you pick makes a big difference?

[Speaker 1] (1:38:42 - 1:39:43)

Yes, yes, I think. Like, the more cricket you play, I think it's for every other art. The more you do something, the better you get at it.

The more you're challenged, the more you, you know, win and lose. The more you see all of that, then your development as a person is better. Well, I came from a school that didn't play cricket at all.

But, you know, my academy played cricket. So, I'd play academy cricket, but I'd get probably 10 games in a year, whereas someone who has a school team will get 30 games in a year. So, there is a difference between that.

And someone who's played… There's nothing to say that just because I played 10 matches, I can't be better than someone who's played 30 games. But if given an option, I'd want to have played 30 or more games, which will help me, you know, realize what are my mistakes, realize where I need to get better, just challenge myself against different oppositions and teams.

Yeah, which helps.

[Speaker 2] (1:39:44 - 1:40:06)

Okay, we'll come back to Rahul. Mr. Aditya. Yes.

Mr. Aditya. How did you decide on the name Bachchan? Very interesting.

Very interesting. Yes. And let me tell you, I've listened to so many of your songs.

I'm a fan also. Thank you. As I'm a fan of Kriti and Rahul.

[Speaker 1] (1:40:06 - 1:40:20)

I don't want this extra complimentary. I'm a huge Shahrukh Khan fan. I love Shahrukh Khan.

Huge, huge Shahrukh Khan fan. I love Shahrukh Khan.

[Speaker 2] (1:40:22 - 1:40:24)

The favorite? I love him. In Bollywood?

[Speaker 1] (1:40:25 - 1:40:31)

He's one of those few people who you're a fan of and then you meet him and become a bigger fan.

[Speaker 2] (1:40:31 - 1:40:31)

Bigger fan.

[Speaker 1] (1:40:31 - 1:40:32)

Doesn't happen.

[Speaker 2] (1:40:32 - 1:40:54)

Every time I come to Bombay, one night I go to Shahrukh's house. The both of us sit down and chat for four hours, five hours, six hours. And the kind of advice the man gives is incredible.

I go to him just for knowledge. We'll call him here one day. With me.

I'll tell him. That's it.

[Speaker 4] (1:40:57 - 1:40:59)

Is that it? Why?

[Speaker 2] (1:40:59 - 1:41:01)

Name changed to Badshah? Shahrukh? That's it?

[Speaker 4] (1:41:01 - 1:41:02)

His fam.

[Speaker 1] (1:41:04 - 1:41:15)

He's fondly called the Badshah. Badshah of Bollywood. But you felt the need to change the name?

My name? Yeah. From Aditya to Badshah?

[Speaker 4] (1:41:15 - 1:41:15)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:41:15 - 1:41:47)

Yeah. Also, you know, somehow you adapt to the... Somebody said that.

No one said it. Before this, I used to rap in English and my name was Kool Equal. What was it?

Because that was my email ID. Kool Equal at hotmail.com. So, at one point, they were putting me on stage and asking me what to say.

I said, Kool Equal. But Badshah was a conscious decision. And then when I told my cousins, that's my board.

[Speaker 2] (1:41:48 - 1:41:56)

I test them. Did you grow up Kool or did you become Kool suddenly? Because now you're very Kool.

Am I Kool? I think so.

[Speaker 1] (1:41:56 - 1:41:57)

Now you're officially.

[Speaker 2] (1:41:58 - 1:42:07)

Now you're officially Kool. I think I'm real. I think the more...

I like that you're prefacing this with real. Then I can ask you anything.

[Speaker 1] (1:42:08 - 1:42:16)

Yeah, of course. Because as far as I've seen you, if you're real, you're Kool. Yeah.

[Speaker 3] (1:42:17 - 1:42:18)

No, man. Who said that?

[Speaker 1] (1:42:19 - 1:43:23)

I mean, if you're a good person. Yeah, I mean, I don't know. If I'm Kool or not.

No, but to be on stage and to be a performer on stage in front of audience, you have to have that Kool quotient to be able to interact with them, to be... You're standing with some people, but you're the center stage, you know? That Kool factor was always there.

How you would develop? Performing is a skill that you develop. But the want to perform is what drives you, you know?

To give the audience the entertainment. If you were there, then what would you want? So that's a big driving factor.

I mean, you want to give in everything that you have. And sometimes you do some things in adrenaline that are good too. Or maybe you're not right for the show.

But at least, you know, you go out there and you do it.

[Speaker 2] (1:43:25 - 1:43:31)

Are you a very emotional person? Very. I saw him tearing up a little bit just now.

[Speaker 4] (1:43:32 - 1:43:32)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:43:33 - 1:43:47)

And for somebody like me who finds it so hard to cry, it intrigues me that is being so emotional a prerequisite to being creative? Because you really have to feel? No, it's…

[Speaker 1] (1:43:49 - 1:44:14)

Sometimes, you know, you don't know how to contain your emotions and tears are a way. I think it's very overwhelming. It's an outlet.

Tell me from your childhood.

[Speaker 2] (1:44:15 - 1:44:23)

I'm genuinely so curious. I want to know everything. What?

What happened in life? Where were you born? Parents, siblings, everything.

[Speaker 3] (1:44:23 - 1:44:24)

All the questions are the same.

[Speaker 2] (1:44:24 - 1:44:25)

All of them?

[Speaker 1] (1:44:25 - 1:44:37)

I was born in Delhi. Dad was in the government job. Mom was a teacher.

What did you do in the government? In the Delhi Electricity Board. He joined as a junior engineer.

[Speaker 2] (1:44:37 - 1:45:01)

That means you were rich. No, we were not. Joking, but continue.

Yeah, money. Everybody, I generally think whoever is in any state, government, board, land, electricity, water, they tend to be rich. Yeah, so I used to ask my dad that what about your colleagues' son?

Next time you come home, there won't be power, water and electricity. But… Yeah, so mom was a teacher.

[Speaker 1] (1:45:02 - 1:45:26)

He retired. Both of them retired. Everyone's mom is a teacher.

Yeah. What is it? Went to a school called Bal Bharti Public School, Pitampura.

Good in studies. Then college. St. Stephen's for a bit. And then I went to Punjab Engineering College where I did engineering. Civil.

[Speaker 2] (1:45:27 - 1:45:34)

What kind of music were you into growing up? What did you listen to? Everything.

But you had a favorite genre, artist?

[Speaker 1] (1:45:34 - 1:46:29)

I started with Punjabi because my mother… We used to listen to a lot of Punjabi music at home. Gurdas Mansaab.

Hans Raj Hans. And then, of course, there was Bollywood. Chitrahaar.

I was introduced to rap in school by a friend whose brother was in Hindu College. So then I listened to Eminem. Tupac.

He first played Backstreet Boys for me. Get Down, Get Down. It was one of his songs.

He had given me a song called Quit Playing Games. It was one of his songs. So I stopped at Get Down because it had a small rap in the middle.

I was stuck there. Then from there, I was exposed to more rap. And then I went to college.

I studied engineering there. And… There was a breeze.

I mean, Chandigarh is a very beautiful place when it comes to music.

[Speaker 4] (1:46:30 - 1:46:30)

Punjab.

[Speaker 1] (1:46:32 - 1:46:45)

Because it's in direct touch with the West. It's straight forward. You don't come to Delhi from Chandigarh.

You go straight to Canada from Chandigarh. Or you go to the US. So the amalgamation of cultures there is very dangerous.

[Speaker 2] (1:46:46 - 1:46:56)

What is the Punjab-Canada connection? Why are so many Punjabis in Canada? And vice versa almost.

I don't know. I think it's the want of a better lifestyle.

[Speaker 1] (1:46:57 - 1:47:01)

And also, you know, if one person leaves, then everyone leaves.

[Speaker 2] (1:47:02 - 1:47:12)

But you're leaving an ecosystem where you have family, help, all that to live. What is… I would assume a harder life in Canada, right?

Yes.

[Speaker 1] (1:47:12 - 1:47:40)

I believe so, it is. But… There's money there.

There are more opportunities. Their mindset… I mean, personally, I feel you can do anything anywhere.

That's what I feel. Anytime. Anywhere.

You can do anything if you want to. But a lot of people don't think like that. So they see an example who has earned a lot of money.

And they all want to do it. You know. And it's very attractive.

It's… It attracts you.

[Speaker 2] (1:47:42 - 1:47:48)

You three are examples of that. I'm sure so many people look at you and are becoming cricketers and actors and singers.

[Speaker 4] (1:47:48 - 1:47:49)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (1:47:49 - 1:47:49)

Right?

[Speaker 3] (1:47:50 - 1:47:50)

I think.

[Speaker 2] (1:47:52 - 1:48:02)

I feel like everybody needs a hero character in their life. That they want to… Yeah.

And all three of you inspire in different ways.

[Speaker 1] (1:48:03 - 1:48:31)

Hope so. Yes, but I know a lot of people who are inspired by this and fail. Which is a bad thing.

They feel that… They have this perception that it's very easy. For example, when I started doing business like when I actively wanted to become a businessman.

I felt it's very easy. Like a restaurant. It's the worst thing.

It's very difficult.

[Speaker 2] (1:48:33 - 1:49:00)

I feel like any industry where passionate people enter, you should not go. You should not go. Including movie business.

Why? Yeah. Nobody who puts money into movies generally makes money.

The odds are very low. People will fund a movie for the proximity of popular people. And it's like a funnel of money coming in from outside to inside.

It gets burnt and then you have to find a new funnel. Restaurants are like that.

[Speaker 1] (1:49:00 - 1:49:02)

But there are people who are making money in movies.

[Speaker 2] (1:49:02 - 1:49:03)

So…

[Speaker 1] (1:49:03 - 1:49:28)

Exactly. People enter by looking at them. Yeah.

But he's right. Like if… If an industry is…

Like a restaurant is very passion-driven. Because of the whim of owning a restaurant… You should enter for the right reasons is what I feel.

Yeah. What is the right reason? I mean, I feel like you have to be passionate and all-in.

You can't think that…

[Speaker 2] (1:49:29 - 1:49:55)

Yeah, let's do it. If your outcome is money, you will statistically do better at the industry where there are least amount of passionate people. The more boring your business, the likelihood of you making money is higher.

So, what does your outcome in your head have to be? If it's money. If your outcome is money, go that way.

Don't go into an industry with a million passionate people who are doing it not for money and compete with them.

[Speaker 1] (1:49:55 - 1:49:56)

My podcast was a success.

[Speaker 2] (1:50:00 - 1:50:03)

Don't swim against the tide, generally, you know.

[Speaker 1] (1:50:05 - 1:50:09)

I mean, honestly, it's not like I ever thought earlier of becoming…

[Speaker 2] (1:50:09 - 1:50:10)

A restauranteur.

[Speaker 1] (1:50:10 - 1:50:40)

No, an entrepreneur also. I didn't really think that I'll start a brand or I'll start something. It all came from, oh, I really like this.

I'm really passionate about skincare. I really want to do this. I'm so interested in it that okay, let me see if I can create a brand.

It was not the other way around that let me create a brand and now let me find where and what brand to create. So, I feel like for me, I believe that's the way to go and not the other way around.

[Speaker 2] (1:50:41 - 1:50:54)

Skincare, again, is a very hard industry to pack. It's cluttered, of course. Very, very hard.

You're doing quite well though. Yeah, touch wood. But again, I feel like…

Have you been looking for wood from that time? There's nothing here. There is.

[Speaker 1] (1:50:54 - 1:51:25)

This is metal. It's next to me. This is concrete.

I've kept it next to me. Yeah, I have a habit of doing that. Yeah.

I get an answer very fast. If I were to ask you to invest, let's say, 2.5-3 crore rupees blindly on a business… How much?

2.5-3 crore. Blindly on a business which will fetch you a profit, a definite profit in the next three years. What would it be?

[Speaker 2] (1:51:25 - 1:52:39)

Today, energy transition. Energy? Transition.

Energy, I feel, is moving from fossil to nuclear, renewable. So everything in that. Maybe an electric vehicle company.

Maybe a battery company. Maybe a solar farm. Maybe some kind of solar-wind combination which gives you 24-hour power.

It's such a big thing, energy, in the world. Like most wars in our history have been fought over it. I feel like systemically, it's changing from fossil to non-fossil.

And whenever these transitions happen, it becomes a really large opportunity. I would say anything in that space. And it's not cool.

It's not sexy. It's very boring. No passionate people are there.

Everybody is there competing over profit. Path of lesser resistance than many other things. You don't even need to create a brand.

You need to create an efficient system product. So I would pick something like that. And the government is on your side.

Government has a lot of incentive in pushing you, giving you incentives, if you are any part of this chain.

[Speaker 1] (1:52:41 - 1:52:51)

What do you look for before you invest in a company? What parameters you look at financially and interpersonally?

[Speaker 2] (1:52:52 - 1:53:01)

I think people matter a lot. I would say sector first, at least 30-40%.

[Speaker 1] (1:53:02 - 1:53:06)

Profit making company or extremely amazing people?

[Speaker 2] (1:53:06 - 1:55:41)

To be honest, the entire of last year, I had this passion project where I was loving consumption brands which are India first in nature. Because I feel like patriotism is a narrative that will increasingly appeal, not just in India, but outside of India. I looked at demographics.

I was like, okay, richest community in America, Indians earning $120,000 GDP per capita, all of that. So Indian brands with the Indian story, some kind of patriotism element in that. And I worked with a lot of founders in that space.

Many. It could be a scooter maker. It could be a fashion apparel brand.

It could be a consumption play, anything. But where we sit today, I think everything is too expensive. I find it very hard to invest into any company in today's ecosystem because multiples and valuations are too pricey for me.

I'll wait for something to change and I'll come back in and start working in that space. But today, I'm not doing anything. I have a passion of seeing Indian products kill it abroad.

I have an energy transition thesis and all of that. But I can't pay somebody 10, 15 times revenue multiples and enter with a capital gain outcome in mind. I'm not even buying public equity anymore.

I'm not even buying stocks. I've just stopped. Last one, two months, I've just...

Your zone is something else. I've just hit pause. I might build an operating business all over again where it might play in the energy transition theme.

I feel like a media business is something I'm flirting with right now. I don't know how it'll play out. There are a couple of new sectors that I like.

But will I invest into a company which is valuing themselves as a multiple of revenue today? I won't. Does that drive you?

Yeah, it does. I feel like companies do well not when they grow very fast and they're doing well in a very optimistic environment. Companies do well over the long term who are able to bear the brunt of a down cycle.

And most companies I see today will find it hard to survive a down cycle.

[Speaker 1] (1:55:42 - 1:55:51)

Reaching a particular point is not that tough. But I think the biggest challenge probably is to keep scaling up.

[Speaker 2] (1:55:53 - 1:56:05)

After a certain level. In India, the consumer is so price conscious that there is no moat of a brand at all. Exactly, I have a question.

I love that he's here to learn.

[Speaker 1] (1:56:05 - 1:56:06)

Yeah, I know. He's like, I'm your interviewer.

[Speaker 4] (1:56:06 - 1:56:08)

He's turning the table on me. I've been waiting for so long.

[Speaker 1] (1:56:09 - 1:56:25)

He's like, they're talking about their childhood. I'm not interested. Can a brand like...

Not a luxury... And not like Sabyasachi. Can a brand like Prada come out of India in the next few years?

Should it come out? 100%. Is it the right time?

100%.

[Speaker 3] (1:56:26 - 1:56:29)

You're meeting now? No, I was toying around.

[Speaker 2] (1:56:29 - 1:56:51)

I'm trying. I'm like looking for a few people in that space. This shirt I'm wearing is from this guy called 1111.

Yeah. But that's not super luxury. It's not super luxury.

But I think it's premium luxury. But I love his story. He's been doing it for 15 years.

Sustainable. The color he dyes it with is in the same bucket for like the last 10-20 years.

[Speaker 1] (1:56:51 - 1:57:15)

But how many people are buying the story? I think it'll increase with time. The story has not been created at all from India.

Everyone fears that it won't happen. Also, it's only now that... We're just so scared to compete.

No, but if you price something, say, expensive in a relative manner, how easy or difficult is it for a new brand to really kickstart in India?

[Speaker 2] (1:57:16 - 1:57:23)

No, I feel like mass premium is a space which is becoming very big in India. And ultra premium more so.

[Speaker 1] (1:57:24 - 1:57:26)

What do you call ultra premium? Give me an example.

[Speaker 2] (1:57:26 - 1:57:34)

Luxury. I would say for a shirt, anything above 15,000 rupees a shirt. I feel like that space is growing.

[Speaker 3] (1:57:34 - 1:57:34)

Is becoming?

[Speaker 2] (1:57:35 - 1:57:56)

It's becoming big. Big here? Yeah.

I would say it's growing faster than the other spaces. And there's a big opportunity there. See, the thing is, right?

There are a lot... Why does somebody buy Prada? It's not for the quality of the fabric.

It's not for the design element. It's to signal to people that I can afford Prada. It's the story of Prada.

[Speaker 1] (1:57:56 - 1:57:58)

Yeah, but that's after Prada is Prada.

[Speaker 2] (1:57:58 - 1:57:58)

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (1:57:58 - 1:58:00)

When Prada is not Prada.

[Speaker 2] (1:58:00 - 1:58:34)

Yeah. And it's just launched. But if you look at all these...

See, Prada is no longer Prada. Prada is part of a big conglomerate where the story is very muddled. If you look at LVMH, if you look at Kering, which owns Gucci, if you look at Burberry, their sales are declining for the first time in a multi-decade period.

They're starting to fire 10% of their staff. I feel like that notion that luxury is not mass-produced but is handmade. This artisan worked on it for four hours, five hours.

He personally did this on the shirt.

[Speaker 1] (1:58:34 - 1:58:37)

But I'm talking about a new brand. I'm talking about a startup.

[Speaker 2] (1:58:37 - 1:58:48)

I think a brand like that can really work. Yeah. I feel like...

I'm not invested in these guys yet but I've been considering it for a year now. Theirs is a story that could work.

[Speaker 1] (1:58:48 - 1:58:56)

Yeah, so that was another question. Would a model like that work? Like establishing a brand outside of India and bringing it back to India?

[Speaker 2] (1:58:57 - 1:59:23)

No, I think we have to break that colonial thing. I don't think we should have Arvind Mills throwing out brands like Louis, Philippe and Peter England. They're getting manufactured in Chennai and all these places.

But they have these foreign names and foreign models and people buy it assuming they're a foreign brand. I think at the core, we have to hit at foreign is no longer better. But how will you change that mindset?

But why hasn't it happened?

[Speaker 1] (1:59:23 - 1:59:23)

Exactly.

[Speaker 2] (1:59:24 - 1:59:40)

It's a tough thing to sell but I feel like you guys are partly the answer to it as well. If you start wearing... See, you're people in society that define what is cool.

You should look inward and build brands versus outwards and build brands.

[Speaker 1] (1:59:40 - 1:59:58)

We want to. I'm sure he already has. But I'm just saying, it's always the fear of everyone you meet says, no, it won't work.

There's so many other existing things. So many people who have tried and failed. Just like you said, why would you enter a place where there are already so many competitors?

[Speaker 2] (1:59:58 - 2:01:16)

But everybody who tried to mimic somebody is failing. But if you do something Indian, luxury, authentic, cool. Cool is defined by you guys.

You control that. But if you show X amount of work went into Y product and charge according to that and clearly distinguish how more work went into this shirt than a Prada or LV or a foreign brand shirt. I think like, I only buy Indian products now.

And I've been vocal about this for a long time. More and more people will start to believe it's cooler. There is a crazy big market in India which is very affluent, which will pay a certain premium for the sake of the premium.

For the bragging rights that come with it. If you price a shirt at… But how do you, when you just start and nobody knows of it.

You can. How do you just make it feel so… Because that itself is your PR.

If you start a shirt and sell it at 15,000 rupees, you might find it hard to sell it. But if you price a shirt at 1 lakh rupees, Indian made, weave a story around it, it will sell itself to a certain extent. Okay, you tell me.

You conveniently digressed and made this about me from this being about you.

[Speaker 3] (2:01:16 - 2:01:18)

Are you looking at me? He did. I know.

[Speaker 1] (2:01:20 - 2:01:24)

What else? Then there was music. Then there was singing.

[Speaker 2] (2:01:26 - 2:01:31)

But there must be a story behind it too. It can't be so simple. There was music, then there was singing.

[Speaker 1] (2:01:33 - 2:01:41)

When did you start writing and everything? I started writing. I was always a writer.

Because I couldn't express. So, I used to write a lot.

[Speaker 3] (2:01:41 - 2:01:42)

Always means? Since when?

[Speaker 1] (2:01:42 - 2:02:03)

Since I remember. I mean, I used to have this thing that if I had a fight with someone in class, I couldn't answer them. And then I used to think later that I could say this, I could say that.

And then I used to pen it down. I don't know why. And then it became a thing.

I started writing. I started rhyming things.

[Speaker 2] (2:02:03 - 2:02:04)

What age was this at?

[Speaker 1] (2:02:05 - 2:02:10)

School. I started from school. And...

[Speaker 2] (2:02:10 - 2:02:15)

And how do you just start writing? How does that happen? Like, I listen to songs, I've never felt like writing a song.

[Speaker 1] (2:02:15 - 2:03:02)

I love writing. So, it started with, you know, there were no lyrics before. There was no internet before.

So, if someone would listen to a song, they would write the lyrics. To sing along. It started from that.

If someone would listen to a song, get down, get down, pause, get down, get down, play. So, first they would write the lyrics, then they would remember them, then they would sing them in school, then they would be cool. That's how it began.

The want to be cool seeks some sort of validation from... I said the same thing, right? On validation, he's looking at me.

I'm like, what is going on? Everybody seeks some sort of validation in a lot of people. And that's how it began, like writing that.

That's how it started. So, when I went to Chandigarh...

[Speaker 2] (2:03:03 - 2:03:04)

Where did you go from Chandigarh?

[Speaker 1] (2:03:04 - 2:04:16)

I went to Chandigarh from Delhi. Why? College.

Punjab Engineering College. My admission was in Civil Engineering. And there, a very beautiful

thing was going on.

You know, the likes of Rishi Rich, Punjabi MC, Bali Sagu, they were blowing up. And... And, I mean, we were thinking, what kind of music are we making?

What kind of music is he making? Why aren't we making such music? And these people on the other side of the globe were putting these sounds together.

And it was just beautiful. Like, as an audience, I still get goosebumps thinking about it. So, when I heard Rishi Rich's dance for the first time, Jayshan's, I didn't even know he was our guy.

Then I wanted to explore it more. So, in the college computer lab, I used to download songs. There were torrents, to download songs from the line wire.

And, my passion kept growing. So, I downloaded a mixing software, made beats on it, and wrote it. And then, once, I was playing basketball somewhere, and while playing there...

[Speaker 2] (2:04:16 - 2:04:22)

Is this easy to do even now? If I'm a budding songwriter who wants to produce? Are there such softwares?

[Speaker 1] (2:04:23 - 2:04:25)

Of course! It's easier than ever.

[Speaker 2] (2:04:25 - 2:04:26)

What would you recommend?

[Speaker 1] (2:04:26 - 2:04:57)

Which software? Splice. It's not a software, it's a website.

Where you get a lot of samples. I mean, as a purist, you feel bad, but, it's made things a lot easier. You get loops, you get drums, you arrange them in 3-4 ways, and you get a beat.

But that also mars your creativity. You know, that... That doesn't let you explore, an idea.

Which is your own. But yeah, there are softwares.

[Speaker 2] (2:04:58 - 2:05:01)

And AI making a big difference? Nonsense! I mean, I...

[Speaker 1] (2:05:02 - 2:05:32)

I hate AI. I love nonsense. I love AI.

As a businessman, I would embrace it. And I keep saying it, that in the future, I think, you can't fight something that's inevitable, right? I think AI is inevitable.

So, maybe like 3-4, maybe 5 years down the line, non-AI songs will be very expensive. If that singer sings with his real voice, then that's like a... Handmade sort of a thing.

[Speaker 2] (2:05:32 - 2:05:45)

But will people care the audience? Yeah. Bragging rights.

Even today it happens, right? Some singers live don't do so well. And then people talk about it, that he sucks live.

Yeah.

[Speaker 1] (2:05:48 - 2:05:57)

Happens. A lot. But technology has made it so easy to become a recording artist.

You know, live... Then live is live.

[Speaker 2] (2:05:57 - 2:05:59)

So the value for an Arijit Singh will never go down?

[Speaker 1] (2:06:00 - 2:06:00)

Never.

[Speaker 2] (2:06:00 - 2:06:01)

People like that? Never.

[Speaker 1] (2:06:02 - 2:06:39)

True, pure art is forever gonna be there. It's what you give to the audience. It's the experience that you give to the audience.

It can be your voice. It can be a moment. It can be an audio-visual experience.

It's what you give to the audience. Not necessarily, you're singing. Travis Scott is not the best rapper.

But it's the experience that he gives to his audience. That's what... It's...

It's about being honest with yourself, I think, eventually.

[Speaker 2] (2:06:39 - 2:06:41)

Live events are growing the fastest, right?

[Speaker 1] (2:06:41 - 2:06:56)

That's one industry where someone who wants to get into music business, that's one industry that... That is the only aspect of music where they should invest. Immensely growing, especially in this part of the world.

[Speaker 2] (2:06:57 - 2:07:00)

People are coming up with venue ideas and all because they feel like it's such a big...

[Speaker 1] (2:07:00 - 2:07:05)

I wanted to collaborate with Ambani and pitch it to Modiji that we don't have infrastructure.

[Speaker 2] (2:07:06 - 2:07:08)

Somebody is trying to build a lyrical piece.

[Speaker 1] (2:07:08 - 2:07:10)

But that would be a game-changer.

[Speaker 2] (2:07:11 - 2:07:17)

Okay, then? So you started writing and then? I started writing.

I started making music.

[Speaker 1] (2:07:18 - 2:08:30)

Met people. And then I met... There was this guy in Chandigarh who was...

I was looking for the right music because I still did not know how to make music. And then I came across Honey who was doing underground stuff in Delhi. Insane.

Insane underground stuff. And I had heard of him because music used to reach you then. Personality did not reach you at that time.

And that was a big thing. So I met his manager. He said...

He heard my rap. He said, did you do this? I said, yes.

He said, where are you from? I said, Canada. He said, I don't think so.

He even gave me my passport. But he was like... He is a guy who makes music.

I said, I know him. He makes insane music. We should work together.

We started working together. I used to write for him. That was your first big break?

Yeah, like first big... Even now, I was doing my job. I was also a government officer.

[Speaker 4] (2:08:31 - 2:08:31)

Really?

[Speaker 1] (2:08:31 - 2:08:32)

Yeah.

[Speaker 4] (2:08:32 - 2:08:33)

Where?

[Speaker 1] (2:08:33 - 2:08:42)

Rich. I... Sundarnagar, Himachal Pradesh.

You also did engineering? When did you reach Himachal, brother? From Chandigarh to Himachal?

[Speaker 3] (2:08:42 - 2:08:43)

Yeah, he did.

[Speaker 1] (2:08:43 - 2:09:54)

Brother, I... You completed your B.Tech? I did.

I did. After college, you went? Yeah, I got a CAT.

I got a good percentile. But I got a government job. Right after I was out of my college.

Then in BBMB, Bhakhra Bihas Management Board, I was... I joined as an STO, Sub-Divisional Officer. I was sent to...

A place called Baggi in Himachal Pradesh, where I used to operate gates. So... Tunnel or water canal gates.

Electricity used to be made there. So why did you go for that? You just like...

I didn't have anything then. I had to do a job. Oh, like that.

So then... I was shuffling between that job and... You know, being with honey and writing for him.

And that's when I knew that... Brother, what I'm doing... No one else is doing it.

I mean... That we're doing it. Like there's no one else who's doing it.

And at that time, there were no rappers in India. When we started. And you were young.

You were like... We'll kill it. So that gave me a lot of confidence.

And so much confidence that it's just us. There's no one else. And that...

That borderline is good too. Borderline is bad too.

[Speaker 2] (2:09:55 - 2:10:01)

And the first song with Honey, you started script writing. And then when did you start doing your own? Script...

[Speaker 1] (2:10:01 - 2:10:03)

Song writing. Song writing. Yes.

[Speaker 2] (2:10:03 - 2:10:04)

And after that?

[Speaker 1] (2:10:04 - 2:11:15)

And after that, in 2011, we parted ways. And in 2011, I realized that I had to learn how to make music. Then I started learning production.

Then I produced a song called Saturday Saturday. Which was released... Locally...

In 2012. Which... Went bonkers in Delhi.

People went crazy. So... 2012...

This is the same song that Varun and Alia... So that's the same song. Okay.

So 2012, it blew up. 2013, Varun and Shashank were partying in a club in Chandigarh. Shashank Khaitan is the director of the film.

So they heard the song. They tried to replicate it. They couldn't.

So Dharma called me up. They were like, Oh, this Saturday Saturday is yours. I was like, yeah.

He said, we want the song. Take it. Then you come to Bombay.

Look at the guts. I said, if you want the song, you come to Chandigarh. That was the sort of confidence that we were riding on.

But then we developed a good... That's how it... Then after a while...

[Speaker 3] (2:11:15 - 2:11:18)

Don't think about it. Is that Chandigarh or is that your...

[Speaker 1] (2:11:18 - 2:11:18)

That's Azeem.

[Speaker 3] (2:11:19 - 2:11:20)

That's him.

[Speaker 1] (2:11:21 - 2:11:24)

Who is Azeem? Music supervisor for Dharma.

[Speaker 2] (2:11:24 - 2:11:34)

Yeah. And then how did it change? Okay, your song was picked up by Dharma and then?

And then it grew bigger. Then... They put it in a movie.

[Speaker 1] (2:11:34 - 2:11:58)

They put it in a movie. But my first big break was... A song called Abhi Toh Party Shuru Hui Hai.

I've heard the song, of course. I was about to say that I didn't... Like...

Of course, I knew Saturday Saturday is a rap. But I didn't know you had produced the whole song. Yeah, so I produced it with one of my friends.

Who taught me how to produce. Sachit Thakkar. Shout out.

Because I remember the rap in that. Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (2:11:59 - 2:12:22)

Which was very cool, yeah. How hard is it to learn how to produce? If I was a young kid and I want to produce my own song?

Not really hard. A month would... If you're totally into it, then a month.

How do I learn it? YouTube. Tutorials.

You can learn how to make a bomb. How to make a? Bomb.

So I go to Slice. I learn how to make a beat.

[Speaker 1] (2:12:22 - 2:12:32)

Splice. Splice. No, you go to YouTube first.

I'll suggest you go to YouTube. Learn production. And once you learn the intricacies of production, you go to all these websites that give you samples.

[Speaker 2] (2:12:32 - 2:12:35)

Is it expensive to buy the equipment needed?

[Speaker 1] (2:12:35 - 2:12:48)

No. No? All you need is a laptop.

And a midi. I bought a speaker yesterday. The one you listen to my final output on.

I mix it on those speakers. 12,000 rupees.

[Speaker 4] (2:12:49 - 2:12:49)

Yeah?

[Speaker 2] (2:12:52 - 2:13:03)

So what would you say to a young budding me who's a... Who wants to produce a song? Some tips?

Why do you want to do it? I want to become a king. I want to become popular and rich.

[Speaker 1] (2:13:04 - 2:13:07)

Don't do it. Why? Get into stocks if you want to be rich.

[Speaker 2] (2:13:08 - 2:13:12)

It's very difficult. But... Same answer.

It's very difficult.

[Speaker 1] (2:13:13 - 2:13:26)

No, I mean, why do you want to become a king? Do you... Like, are you passionate for music?

Or if I tell you not to do it, scold you for not doing it, and if you do it again tomorrow, then you should do it.

[Speaker 2] (2:13:26 - 2:13:27)

Hmm.

[Speaker 1] (2:13:28 - 2:14:51)

So I should have an innate... 100 percent. Then you'll be a successful one.

It'll take time. And it's all a matter of time. Jay-Z once said that the only genius thing that I did was not giving up.

If you're truly passionate, then I think it's only a matter of time. And that's the biggest challenge, I think. It's a beautiful line though.

Yeah. He's got some crazy quotes. Yeah.

One of his quotes, which is not actually his, but... Something that I also just said, but I think it's the same story when you're like... It's all about not giving up.

And do you know what it depends on? I think that depends on your passion. There is no other way to define it.

If you're really passionate, you'll make music when someone listens to you. You'll make it when no one listens to you. Passion and also some sort of belief that you know you can.

Yeah. Otherwise, it's easy to give up, yeah. It is so...

It's so easy to give up. But I think you'll always love to play cricket. Since I was, let's say, eight, nine, I had only one plan in my life.

I didn't have any plan B. I can't think of like... A lot of times they ask me, okay, if you were not a cricketer, what else would you become?

I said, I have no idea.

[Speaker 4] (2:14:51 - 2:14:52)

A struggling cricketer.

[Speaker 1] (2:14:52 - 2:16:06)

Yeah, a struggling cricketer. I've never thought about what else could I do. I said, okay, worst thing, if cricket didn't work out, I'd have played some other sport, maybe.

If that didn't happen, then I don't know. I mean, that's... It's never...

But that's all you know. Because that's... You love it so much.

And I think in some way that helps. I think for me it's a little different. I think I fell in love with acting...

After you started acting. Yeah. Yeah.

While I started doing it. You're a very diligent person, you know that? Uh-huh.

Yeah. That I want to do this. Yeah, I have that thing.

That if I want to do it, I want to give it like my 100 percent. And do it properly. But I liked doing it.

I thought I could. I thought I had it in me to do it. So, first belief came from that.

I was enjoying it. But actual love for acting happened a little later where I got way deeper into it. In the beginning, you're doing it superficially.

You don't even know where the mark is. You don't even know where the camera is. I know.

So, I feel like it takes... It took me some time. I was not one of those who's done like...

It's just acting. I can't think of anything else. I'm just breathing this.

It wasn't like that. And acting is so much... It became that.

More than just...

[Speaker 2] (2:16:06 - 2:16:24)

You know, where's the light? Where's the camera? You both are in an industry where it's a finite curve of time.

You have a peak at a certain age and... Is there insecurity around that?

[Speaker 1] (2:16:27 - 2:16:36)

There's no insecurity. But there's a feeling of... At least for me, there's a feeling that all this ends.

And for me, it ends pretty quickly.

[Speaker 2] (2:16:37 - 2:16:38)

What age does it end at?

[Speaker 1] (2:16:38 - 2:17:16)

I mean, if you're healthy and fit enough, if you can carry yourself, then maybe till 40. You can play till 40. That's the maximum one's played.

Yes, there is MS Dhoni who's playing. He's 43 now and he's still playing. You can play the IPL and all of that.

But not at the international level. For too long. So there's that fear that all this...

I don't know if it's fear. But there's fear come realization that the shelf life is really small for an athlete. And you need to make the most of it within whatever time you have.

[Speaker 2] (2:17:16 - 2:17:26)

Is that a trigger to anxiety? Because your importance amongst your peers or amongst people even goes down at that point slightly?

[Speaker 1] (2:17:26 - 2:18:14)

No, for me, the anxiety was... Like, I think when I hit 30, I could see the end of the tunnel. Till I was 29, I couldn't see that.

I'd never thought about, oh, there is... You know, cricket is going to come to an end at some point. So it was some weird thing that happened the minute my 30th birthday.

I was like, I could see, you know, I have probably 10 more years left to play cricket. And that gave me a bit of like... Anxiety.

And that's the first time I felt like, shit, it comes to an end at some point. Because all I've done my whole life was cricket, cricket, cricket without knowing when, without ever imagining that it'll ever come to an end. Now, you can probably...

I mean, I can see it. It's not too far away now.

[Speaker 2] (2:18:14 - 2:18:16)

What happens after it ends, Rahul?

[Speaker 1] (2:18:18 - 2:19:43)

I don't know. That's something that is... That's part of the reason why I've started thinking about businesses and started thinking about investing my money, right?

So my life after cricket can be taken care of. I know there'll be a huge dip in the amount I earn once I finish cricket. So, yeah, that's where...

And COVID for me happened at that right time where it gave me time to sit and really do some research about how can I invest money. I don't come from a family where, you know, like... You generally lean on your family to guide you when you start earning.

So I didn't have that guidance. So it's very new for my dad as well who mostly helps me with my finances. So it gave me some time to understand what do I need to do?

How can I invest? And yeah, I met some good people and I had good friends. So they gave me that guidance.

And through COVID, I started understanding that. That's what I'm trying to do. And hopefully, I can set up a few things before I retire.

So once I retire, I can... You know, that transition from being an athlete to doing something in business it might be smooth and it will make me a bit more happier than not knowing what I'm doing.

[Speaker 4] (2:19:44 - 2:19:45)

Do you, Kriti?

[Speaker 1] (2:19:46 - 2:19:56)

I don't know if it causes an insecurity or not. I think... Would you say that...

till I can function?

[Speaker 2] (2:19:57 - 2:20:01)

Would you say the age curve is similar? You peak as an actress up until 40?

[Speaker 1] (2:20:01 - 2:21:50)

Yes, but I think there's a little difference of if you evolve and mold yourself to what you should be doing after a certain age and don't shy away from that. For example, after a certain age, you cannot play a college student. You know, even though Aamir Khan has done it.

It's just tough. Physically, you look a certain way which beyond a certain point is not in your hands. So no matter how well you maintain yourself no matter how, you know, you will age and

you have to be mindful of that.

So while yes, I do want to work I do want to act till my body allows it and till I can I know that at a certain point I will have to understand that this role I cannot do it. I need to transition to something which suits me and suits my age and a different kind of character different kind of a film. But I still want to keep going.

I feel like it used to be a lot more limited earlier that if you're married, you can't, you know at least for women, it used to be like that. And I feel like right now it's very different whether you see a Bebo or, you know, Priyanka or so many people who who are kids and they've gotten back into shape and they're working and they're like at it you know Vidya, so many of them. So you just have to be mindful of you can't be stuck in a particular zone and be wanting to do the same thing and then feel rejected that you're not getting that.

I think I mean, I don't think it's hit me yet it will at some point but I'm not like unaware of it.

[Speaker 2] (2:21:52 - 2:21:58)

You don't have that issue, right? Of course, we have. Time?

Like A.

[Speaker 1] (2:21:58 - 2:21:58)

R.

[Speaker 2] (2:21:58 - 2:22:00)

Rahman is how old now?

[Speaker 1] (2:22:00 - 2:23:14)

See again as a musician, there is no age. As an actress, there is no age. You can act till you die.

To stay relevant is the challenge. Gurdas Mahan sir told me something which was I didn't understand then but now I do. Your work doesn't change.

People's eyes and ears change. You do the same thing. But you suddenly someday stop being relevant.

That phenomenon, how does it happen? Why does it happen? I don't know.

But I also feel like you gotta evolve and 100% keep up with the changing times. 100% I mean, Diljit bhaji has been singing for I was in school for 22 years I've been singing since then. So, you have to and I'm trying to figure it out.

I mean, you know what happens after a certain age? An artist's, a creative's ego comes in. That no, it used to be like this.

It used to be like this in my time. This is how the world is. You you always have to be open to learning.

[Speaker 2] (2:23:15 - 2:23:25)

Always. Always. Is that a big thing?

Precursor to success? Ability to change fast? Absolutely.

Faster than competition? Absolutely.

[Speaker 1] (2:23:26 - 2:23:43)

Ability to be okay not knowing everything and to be willing to change? Absolutely. Like, you do not know anything.

And the ability to adapt. Yeah. The sooner you adapt, the the greater you will be in your in your profession.

[Speaker 2] (2:23:44 - 2:24:16)

You don't have to keep up with the times. You have to move ahead of the times. The one thing all of you have going for yourself is the aura of coolness.

You're also relevant because you're also cool. I don't know which one comes before the other. How important is this enigma element?

How important is being inaccessible towards building enigma? I really honestly You don't work on it actively? No.

[Speaker 1] (2:24:18 - 2:24:22)

I'm not very sure if I even feel that I'm very cool.

[Speaker 2] (2:24:23 - 2:24:24)

That is also cool, no?

[Speaker 1] (2:24:25 - 2:24:25)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (2:24:26 - 2:24:28)

I don't think if I was Not thinking you're cool is also cool.

[Speaker 1] (2:24:29 - 2:24:43)

Yeah, I don't think I paid too much So my stylist sometimes Who do you think is cool? We have this banter. Who do I think is cool?

In terms of styling? In terms of what? Who's cool?

I think Shah Rukh Khan is cool.

[Speaker 2] (2:24:43 - 2:24:44)

Why is Shah Rukh Khan cool?

[Speaker 1] (2:24:45 - 2:24:58)

Because there is this sense of confidence in him while he's intelligent. And he's witty. He can still entertain you, make you laugh and also laugh at himself.

[Speaker 4] (2:25:01 - 2:25:04)

He can be charming. He can be You're cool.

[Speaker 1] (2:25:05 - 2:25:15)

He can be charming. He can be Like I think he molds himself in where he is. He can make you laugh in a serious conversation.

I think that's cool.

[Speaker 2] (2:25:16 - 2:25:49)

I've said this to Shah Rukh before but I feel like he has this duopoly at play at every given point. What did you say? Shah Rukh is No, what was that word?

No, leave that. At least tell me. He's able to project arrogance and humility in the same conversation and drift between one end to another in a very tactful manner.

The art of getting away with it. But tell me that word first. Duopoly.

Duo? Duopoly. Monopoly, duopoly.

[Speaker 4] (2:25:49 - 2:25:50)

Okay, duopoly.

[Speaker 2] (2:25:51 - 2:26:44)

I feel like he does it so tactfully it's incredible to watch. I feel like whoever has a personality to get some depth into it you have to add an antithesis almost. Like if I know Kriti to be a nice girl who is articulate did well at school did well does what she's supposed to do I think Kriti becomes cooler when there's another element added to it.

It could be mischief it could be naughtiness it could be her opinion of a certain thing. I feel like Shah Rukh does that very well. I think conviction is cool.

I think if you're if you have conviction I think you'll Basically somebody who doesn't second-guess themselves. And that helps in all three industries, right? Yeah, yeah.

What's your first favorite animal? This is different.

[Speaker 1] (2:26:44 - 2:27:28)

What's your most favorite animal? Lion. Lion, right?

What's your second favorite animal? Umm... Elephant.

What's your third favorite animal? Umm... A wolf.

A wolf? Yeah. Why?

I love that you know all this, man. What? If you had asked me, I would have taken 10 hours to answer.

Is it your favorite animal? Yeah! I don't have 1, 2, 3.

No, it's not like... Yeah, but it's just... Why?

It is. Umm... It's the...

It's the pack mentality. And it's the... Wolf pack.

Yeah, the pack mentality. And the pack always stays together. Brilliant answers.

I'll come to you with the answers. What's your first favorite animal? Most favorite.

Cheetah.

[Speaker 2] (2:27:28 - 2:27:29)

Second?

[Speaker 1] (2:27:30 - 2:27:30)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (2:27:32 - 2:27:36)

Umm... Elephant. Third?

Dog.

[Speaker 4] (2:27:36 - 2:27:37)

Why?

[Speaker 2] (2:27:38 - 2:27:41)

Why? Cute.

[Speaker 1] (2:27:42 - 2:27:44)

Is loyalty a factor? Loyalty.

[Speaker 2] (2:27:47 - 2:27:49)

Always in a good mood.

[Speaker 1] (2:27:49 - 2:27:50)

Loving.

[Speaker 2] (2:27:50 - 2:28:17)

Yeah, I love people who are always in a good mood. I hate people who take themselves too seriously. I tell people like, make fun of me.

Let me make fun of you. There are these people who take offense over the smallest thing. I don't hate anything more than that.

You know? Small things. So hard to be around them.

Forgiving people. I love people who are forgiving. If there is one underrated quality in people I love, it's people who forgive.

[Speaker 1] (2:28:17 - 2:29:09)

When you're loyal, you tend to forgive. And you are. So your first favorite animal signifies...

Okay, the first is actually lion. Second, I would feel a horse. The third is dogs.

I love dogs. I feel like they're loving. They're loyal.

They're... Compassionate. Loyalty is a huge factor.

Yeah, for me as a person, it is. So your first favorite animal is what... You project...

What people think... What you think people think of you. Your second favorite animal is what you think you are.

And your third favorite animal is who you really are. I'm a dog.

[Speaker 2] (2:29:10 - 2:29:12)

I'm a dog. You're also a dog. I'm a dog.

[Speaker 3] (2:29:12 - 2:29:14)

And you're a wolf. But then we all have...

[Speaker 2] (2:29:14 - 2:29:14)

That pack mentality.

[Speaker 3] (2:29:15 - 2:29:21)

Yeah. I think I never looked at wolves... Like that.

You'd be surprised...

[Speaker 1] (2:29:21 - 2:29:29)

They never had a fascination. Even though I did a film called Bhediya. But I didn't look at them like that.

How many people said snake?

[Speaker 2] (2:29:31 - 2:29:34)

I'm petrified of snakes. I'm very scared of snakes.

[Speaker 3] (2:29:34 - 2:29:40)

I don't like reptiles. I think Kriti has to go. Yes, I do.

I've already pushed her. We'll continue for a bit. Please do.

[Speaker 4] (2:29:41 - 2:29:41)

Bro.

[Speaker 3] (2:29:42 - 2:29:43)

Miss me. Treat me like Mr. India.

[Speaker 4] (2:29:43 - 2:29:44)

Yeah, okay.

[Speaker 3] (2:29:44 - 2:29:47)

See you. Talk to me. I see you guys.

[Speaker 2] (2:29:51 - 2:30:14)

Now that Kriti is gone... We can talk like boys. Let's start with...

Babs and all... What's going on? Tell us.

In the world of boys... Which girl are you dating today?

[Speaker 1] (2:30:15 - 2:30:16)

Today?

[Speaker 2] (2:30:19 - 2:30:32)

No one. Why? You must have had so much access, right?

With all these videos and all of that. We keep watching it on TV.

[Speaker 1] (2:30:34 - 2:31:07)

No one. I'm not dating anyone. I cannot.

You cannot? It takes away my focus. In fact, recently I've...

I've separated a lot of people from my life. Because they were distracting you? Distracting me a little bit.

Which sounds a little selfish. But a little bit of answerability... Or a little bit of time division...

Was hindering my... In my mind, a higher purpose.

[Speaker 2] (2:31:08 - 2:31:16)

Is a relationship important for feeling whole as an individual? No. No.

Rahul would disagree, right?

[Speaker 1] (2:31:16 - 2:31:17)

Yeah, I would disagree.

[Speaker 2] (2:31:17 - 2:31:24)

Depends on the person. What do you get from a relationship that he's not cognizant to be missing?

[Speaker 1] (2:31:25 - 2:32:23)

I don't know if he's missing. I can tell you what helps me with my relationship. It's just having someone you go back home to who's...

Who loves me, cares for me. Regardless of my performance or what the people outside are saying. She's my safe space.

She's my escape. She's a lot of things. She keeps me grounded.

She's amazing, by the way. Yeah, she is amazing. I'm very lucky.

I'm very grateful. But yeah, just in general, I think relationships help you... Like, I feel like help you stay a lot more focused.

And I have been out of relationships and played. Like while I was... Before I dated Athiya, I was single for a long time.

And I can confidently say that there were a lot... My mind would waver a lot more than it does now.

[Speaker 2] (2:32:23 - 2:32:23)

Stability.

[Speaker 1] (2:32:24 - 2:32:24)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (2:32:24 - 2:32:25)

Yeah?

[Speaker 1] (2:32:25 - 2:32:25)

Yeah.

[Speaker 2] (2:32:26 - 2:32:28)

Makes a big difference at work? Stability?

[Speaker 1] (2:32:28 - 2:33:33)

Massive. Massive. For me, it does.

It's different. I go back to my parents. Yeah.

I think that purpose is solved by me being around my parents. Family is family. No one can take that place.

But in the same way, no one can take the place of your partner. Like I don't think that's something that anyone else can give you. That I think it's very important for...

At least important, very important for me. That I have that stability and that love and that partnership. Who's also like, you know, same age.

We're still like, you know, finding our own selves, finding our own individual selves. Still working, still doing our things. We'll still give our space.

But, you know, we always come back to each other. And it's not that you feel like there's a compulsion to come together. But you just want to.

You just like, both of you just come together at the end of the day. And it's beautiful.

[Speaker 2] (2:33:34 - 2:33:36)

Do you think we missed anything today?

[Speaker 1] (2:33:36 - 2:33:38)

What do you think about relationships?

[Speaker 2] (2:33:40 - 2:33:43)

I get into trouble each time I talk about relationships.

[Speaker 1] (2:33:43 - 2:33:48)

One last time. For the sake of someone who does not believe me.

[Speaker 2] (2:33:49 - 2:34:32)

I think relationships are wonderful. But I don't see the need to tie what is a wonderful thing with a societal construct with a bunch of rules that I might not agree with. I feel like I can be madly in

love with someone but not want to subject our relationship to the rules derived from society which might have worked for some other people.

But I like being in relationships. I'm like a relationship junkie. I've been in a relationship all my life.

[Speaker 1] (2:34:32 - 2:34:34)

I can't think of a time when you were single.

[Speaker 2] (2:34:35 - 2:35:10)

Yeah, ask him. I've never been single. But what do you think we missed?

We started off today trying to achieve one outcome. How to help a singer, rapper, producer, a cricketer, an actor who wants to make it. What can we tell them that they might not have seen because it's a more nuanced advice and not something generic.

Is there something else? Like a tip? What will a 20-year-old wannabe singer say?

I think more producer, not singer.

[Speaker 1] (2:35:11 - 2:37:44)

As a musician, I think prerequisite would be the want. Why do you want to do it? And if the want is you love music, then you should just be original.

And it's easier said than done. I mean, because you start by listening to someone and you get inspired and then you subconsciously copy them. But everyone in this world is different and you need to.

So this is what, this is where I come in. This is where help comes in. Be inspired, don't be influenced.

Be inspired, which is fine. You are as unique as your DNA. Even if your story is exactly the same as someone else's.

But if I say that I'm going to pee in my own way, that is my story and that is cool. That is me. And people will listen to it.

If you say it with conviction, if you have a reason to tell it to people, do that. And do not give up. The biggest virtue that is going to help you is patience.

While you make it, even after you make it, you just learn to be patient. And that is something that I'm learning, revisiting, being patient. Because once you become successful, you become less patient.

That's the most stupid thing. Just to have like, I guess we've missed what a big part the fight in you is. You need to have a little bit of a dog in you.

You know, you need to have that. Like you keep saying hard work, everyone does hard work. But how can you work, like outwork someone else who your competition is, is what will set you apart from someone else.

I think patience and hard work over a long period of time with patience is what's very important. Kaji? Mere se hai?

Haan. As an entrepreneur, as an investor, as someone who wants to be a successful businessman, who does not know, who's a wannabe businessman like me. Because of the aur kya kar sakte hain?

To leverage the brand.

[Speaker 2] (2:37:45 - 2:38:35)

Don't do something like we discussed earlier, where too many passionate people are competing over passion. Stay away from anything that is cool today. Stay away from the flavor of the season.

These tend to be hard, expensive spaces to enter. And pick a sector first. Then focus on what company you want to build in because you want tailwinds in whatever you're trying to build.

Sector mein jaise? Sector jaise ki what do I think as a sector, as an industry will be five times as big 10 years from now as it is today. Spend as much time as you can researching what that sector is.

Then figure out what to build in that sector. Give me an example of a sector.

[Speaker 1] (2:38:35 - 2:38:36)

Jaise health ho gaya, wellness ho gaya.

[Speaker 2] (2:38:36 - 2:38:39)

Health care, energy transition.

[Speaker 1] (2:38:40 - 2:38:41)

As a sector you should.

[Speaker 2] (2:38:41 - 2:38:55)

Yeah, I feel like we spend so much time figuring out what product to build but very little time

figuring out how well the sector is doing today and will likely do in the future. I feel like a lot of effort has to go in towards researching it.

[Speaker 1] (2:39:00 - 2:39:27)

And is it the same way like how I said you need to like, you know, like he said as well, you need to have a lot of patience with our type of work where you will not see success for a long time but you still need to keep doing what you do and then you find it or in business it is be real about it. If it's not working, then just say no, it's not working and move ahead.

[Speaker 2] (2:39:27 - 2:39:35)

In my experience, I find like something either works from the very beginning or it never works at all. Really?

[Speaker 1] (2:39:35 - 2:39:36)

Yeah. There's no in between.

[Speaker 2] (2:39:36 - 2:39:37)

I don't think…

[Speaker 1] (2:39:37 - 2:39:38)

Very beginning is…

[Speaker 2] (2:39:38 - 2:39:40)

First couple of years. One, two, three years.

[Speaker 1] (2:39:40 - 2:39:40)

Couple of years.

[Speaker 2] (2:39:41 - 2:40:10)

Because a lot of people keep waiting for like five years, six years, seven years thinking it'll turn around. Those tend to be bleeding projects. If something is not working, ditch it fast.

The only finite element… The only finite element here is time. Don't have an ego about your failures.

Dump them faster than the next guy. Because at the end of the day, time is the only finite thing. And you will try something and something will work.

[Speaker 1] (2:40:10 - 2:40:21)

Sorry, I'm a little greedy. Last question. How much time does it normally take to find out if it's a good business or a bad business?

How much? One year, two years.

[Speaker 2] (2:40:21 - 2:41:23)

One, two years. One and two, maybe… Two years.

Let's assume two years. I feel like if in two years you have not gotten any traction or significant traction, you should reconsider. But I feel like India is the place to build companies right now.

So much money is coming in from outside, chasing entrepreneurship in India. We living here have this proximity advantage. For example, if a foreigner comes and puts money in company X, I might know him from my area.

I might have heard of him from 10 other friends. It's significantly easier for us to pick industries and companies and people compared to foreigners. I think we should use that advantage and field more entrepreneurship in India.

Thank you. Thank you, guys. Thank you so much for coming.

And thank you, everybody.

[Speaker 4] (2:41:25 - 2:41:25)

Bye.

[Speaker 2] (2:41:27 - 2:41:28)

Done.